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New York City

New York (known as "The Big Apple", "NYC," and often called "New York City") is a global center for media, entertainment, art, fashion, research, finance, and trade. The bustling, cosmopolitan heart of the 4th largest metropolis in the world and by far the most populous city in the United States, New York has long been a key entry point and a defining city for the nation.

From the [Statue of Liberty](#) in the harbor to the Empire State Building towering over the Manhattan skyline, from the tunnels of the subway to the riches of Wall Street, from the bright signs of Times Square to the naturalistic beauty of [Central Park](#), and from Yankee Stadium in the Bronx to Coney Island in Brooklyn, New York's landmarks are quintessential American landmarks. The city's neighborhoods and streets are so iconic they have become ingrained into the American consciousness. Here the power, wealth and culture of the United States is on full display in one of the largest and most iconic skylines in the world, in the food and music to be found around every corner, and in the diverse population of immigrants who come from every corner of the globe to take part in what this city has to offer.

Lying at the mouth of the Hudson River in the southernmost part of the [state of the same name](#) and at the center of the [Mid-Atlantic](#) region, New York City is home to approximately 8.3 million people. The [New York Metropolitan Area](#), which spans lower New York state, northern [New Jersey](#), and southwestern [Connecticut](#), has a population of 18.9 million, making it the largest metropolitan area in the U.S.

See also: [New York City with children](#) and [LGBT New York City](#)

Boroughs

New York City consists of five **boroughs**, which are five separate counties. Each borough has a unique culture and could be a large city in its own right. Within each borough individual **neighborhoods**, some only a few blocks in size, have personalities lauded in music and film. Where you live, work, and play in New York says something to New Yorkers about who you are.

The five New York boroughs are:



Manhattan (New York County)
The famous island between the Hudson and East Rivers where most of the skyscrapers are, with many diverse and unique

neighborhoods. Manhattan is home to the Empire State Building in Midtown, Central Park, Times Square, Wall Street, Harlem, and the trendy neighborhoods of Greenwich Village and SoHo. It is also home to One World Trade Center in Lower Manhattan, which is the largest skyscraper in the western hemisphere as of 2023.

Brooklyn (Kings County)
The most populous borough, and formerly a separate city, south and east of Manhattan across the East River. Known for artists, music venues, beaches, and Coney Island.

Queens (Queens County)
U-shaped and located to the east of Manhattan, across the East River, and north, east, and south of Brooklyn. Queens is the home of the city's two international airports, the New York Mets professional baseball team, the United States Open Tennis Center, and New York City's largest Chinatown (in Flushing). With over 170 languages spoken, Queens is the most ethnically diverse region in the United States, and one of the most diverse in the world.

The Bronx (Bronx County)
A primarily residential borough north of Manhattan, the Bronx is home to the Bronx Zoo, the New York Botanical Gardens, and the New York Yankees professional baseball team. It's also known as the birthplace of hip-hop and rap. The borough contains the largest park in New York City, Pelham Bay Park, which is three times larger than Central Park. It is the only borough in the city that is part of mainland New York State.

Staten Island (Richmond County)
A large island in New York Harbor, south of Manhattan and just across the narrow Kill Van Kull from New Jersey. The borough has the unfortunate nickname of *The Forgotten Borough*, due to the fact that it lacks a subway connection and has a weaker political influence compared to the other boroughs. Unlike most of the rest of New York City, much of Staten Island has a somewhat suburban character.



New York City regions - Color-coded map



Understand

New York City is a major global center of international finance, politics, communications, film, music, fashion, and culture, and is among the world's most important and influential cities. It is home to many world-class museums, art galleries, and theaters. Many of the world's largest corporations have their headquarters here. The headquarters of the United Nations is in New York and most countries have a consulate here. This city's influence on the world and all its inhabitants is hard to overstate, as decisions made within its boundaries often have impacts and ramifications around the globe.

Immigrants (and their descendants) from over 180 countries live here, making it one of the most cosmopolitan cities in the world. Travelers are attracted to New York City for its culture, energy and cosmopolitanism.

History

The first human settlers are believed to have arrived in the area at around 7000 BCE, though this settlement was later abandoned. A subsequent wave of settlers, known as the Lenape people, would then arrive at around 1000 BCE. Although they have been largely wiped out from the area since the days of European settlement, many of the thoroughfares used by them, such as Broadway, continue to be in use to this day.

The first Europeans to settle in the area were the Dutch in 1609, who named the colony New Amsterdam (Dutch: *Nieuw Amsterdam*). The colony was conquered by the British in 1664, who re-named the colony New York. Columbia University, the most prestigious in the city, and one of the most prestigious in the United States, was founded during the British colonial period in 1754.

For much of the War of Independence, New York City remained a British stronghold. The British only withdrew from the city in 1783, allowing George Washington's troops to march in and claim it for the United States of America. New York City became the first capital of the United States of America in 1789, though this status was short-lived as the capital was transferred to Philadelphia only a year later. Nevertheless, during that period, the first United States Congress was convened at what is now Federal Hall on Wall Street, and George Washington was also inaugurated as the



The famous Empire State Building at 350 Fifth Avenue

first President of the United States on the steps of Federal Hall. The Supreme Court of the United States was first convened at the now-demolished Royal Exchange Building, which was adjacent to Federal Hall.

Orientation

The borough of Manhattan is a long, narrow island nestled in a natural harbor. It is separated from The Bronx on the north east by the Harlem River (actually a tidal strait); from Queens and Brooklyn to the east and south by the East River (also a tidal strait); and from the State of New Jersey to the west and north by the Hudson River. Staten Island lies to the southwest, across Upper New York Bay.



Central Park is pretty at any time of the year.

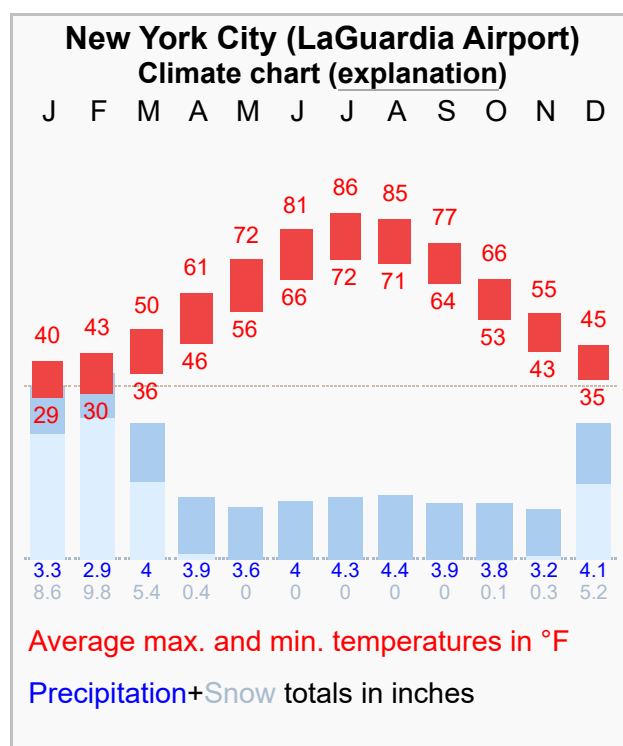


In Manhattan, the terms “uptown” and “north” mean northeast, while “downtown” and “south” mean to the southwest. To avoid confusion, simply use “uptown” and “downtown.” Street numbers continue from Manhattan into the Bronx, and the street numbers rise as one moves farther uptown (however, in the Bronx, there is no simple numerical grid, so there may be 7 blocks between 167 St. and 170 St., for example). Avenues run north and south. In Brooklyn, street numbers rise as one moves south. Queens streets are laid out in a perpendicular grid – street numbers rise as one moves toward the east, and avenues run east and west. Staten Island's grid system is small and insignificant, only covering one neighborhood.

The term “the city” may refer either to New York City as a whole, or to the borough of Manhattan alone, depending on the context. The other boroughs - Brooklyn, The Bronx, Staten Island, and Queens - are sometimes referred to as the “outer boroughs.”

Climate

There has been a pronounced local warming trend in New York City since the 1990s, but the climate is still temperate, except in the summer. Due to its proximity to the humid continental climate zone of the north, it generally experiences all four seasons, with hot and humid summers (Jun-Sept), mild to cool falls (Sept-Nov), mild to very cold winters (Dec-Mar), and increasingly mild, wet springs (Mar-Jun). Average highs for January are around 38°F (3°C) and average highs for July are about 84°F (29°C). However, temperatures in the winter can go down to as low as 0°F (-18°C), although periods of sustained extreme cold with highs in the teens or low 20s for two weeks or more are increasingly a thing of the past, whereas what used to be freakish temperatures in the 70s in midwinter are increasingly common, and in the



summer, temperatures can go above 100°F (38°C). Summer heat indices factoring in

humidity are around 87 °F (31 °C) during the day and 71 °F (22 °C) at night, though it's not unheard of for heat indices to climb up to or exceed 100 °F (38 °C) and not go below 78 °F (26 °C) at night. The temperature in any season is quite variable and it is not unusual to have a sunny 60°F (16°C) day in January followed by a snowy 25°F (-4°C) day. New York can also be prone to snowstorms and nor'easters (large storms similar to a tropical storm), which can dump as much as 2 feet (60 cm) of rain and/or snow in 24–48 hours. Although snowstorms occur during the winter months, some winters see very little snow, and snow rarely lies more than a few days before it melts. Major snowstorms can happen as early as Thanksgiving (the fourth Thursday in November) and as late as the second week in April, though this is increasingly rare and not the norm. Tropical storms can also hit New York City in the summer and early fall, and with climate change occurring apace, they can bring truly torrential rains that cause flooding in places. The sun is up during the summer from 5:30AM to 8:30PM, and 7:15AM to 4:30PM in the winter.

People

The diverse population runs the gamut from some of America's wealthiest celebrities and socialites to homeless people. New York's population, formed by millions of immigrants, has been diverse since the city's founding by the Dutch, and successive waves of immigration from virtually every nation in the world make New York a giant social experiment in cross-cultural harmony.

The city's ethnic heritage illuminates different neighborhoods throughout the five boroughs. Manhattan's Chinatown remains a vibrant center of New York City's Chinese community, though the very large Chinese community in Flushing, Queens, has rivaled if not eclipsed it in importance, and three other Chinatowns have formed in New York City: the Brooklyn Chinatown in Sunset Park; the Elmhurst Chinatown in Queens; and the Avenue U Chinatown in the Homecrest section of Brooklyn. Traces of the Lower East Side's once-thriving Jewish community still exist amid the gentrified neighborhood's trendy restaurants and bars, but there are Chasidic communities in Borough Park, Crown Heights and Williamsburg, Brooklyn. Harlem has been gentrifying and diversifying and remains a center of African-American culture in New York. East (Spanish) Harlem, though also significantly gentrified, still justifies its reputation as a large Hispanic neighborhood. Little known to most tourists are the large Dominican neighborhoods of Hamilton Heights and Washington Heights in upper Manhattan. Brooklyn's Greenpoint is famous for its formerly large and vibrant Polish community, of which only a bit remains, and the Flatbush section - once home to the Brooklyn Dodgers - is today a huge and thriving Caribbean and West Indian section. Queens and Brooklyn are known for being home to many of New York's immigrant groups, which since 1990 have included large numbers of Russians, Uzbeks, Chinese, Irish, French, Filipinos, Yugoslavians, Indians, Pakistanis, Bangladeshis, Japanese, Koreans, Thais, Africans, Arabs (from throughout the Middle East and northern Africa), Persians, Mexicans, Dominicans, Ecuadorians, Puerto Ricans, Brazilians, Colombians and Jamaicans. Queens is the single most diverse area on Earth, having the most languages and ethnic groups living in one place.

Economy

New York City is home to 46 of the Fortune 500 companies. Its gross metropolitan product of \$1.7 trillion is the largest of any American city and represents roughly 9% of the American economy. If it were a nation, the city would have the 16th-highest GDP in the world.

New York is the national center for several industries. It is the home of the three largest U.S. stock exchanges (NYSE, NASDAQ, and AMEX) and many banking and investment firms. Though these companies have traditionally been located in the area around Wall Street in the Financial District, many have offices in other parts of the city, such as Midtown. New York is the hub of the country's publishing, fashion, accounting, advertising, media, legal, theater, and art industries. The city boasts several top-tier hospitals and medical schools, which train more physicians than those in any other city in the world.

Visitor information

- [New York City Tourism \(https://www.nyctourism.com/\)](https://www.nyctourism.com/)

Talk

English is the primary language spoken by most New Yorkers, although it is common to hear other languages from around the world. There are many Spanish-speaking neighborhoods with large Latino populations (especially several neighborhoods in the Bronx, Bushwick, Corona, Jackson Heights, Washington Heights, East Harlem and West Harlem), and it is possible, albeit somewhat difficult, for a non-English-speaking tourist to get by in New York speaking only Spanish. Many establishments in the main commercial and tourist areas have Spanish-speaking staff on duty. Cantonese is the main language among New York City's Chinese community, though a significant minority are immigrants from Fuzhou and hence speak the Fuzhou dialect; some speak Mandarin. You can expect to hear Russian spoken on the streets in parts of South Brooklyn, and Yiddish or Hebrew in other parts. In some of these neighborhoods, some locals may not speak very good English, but store owners and those who would deal frequently with tourists or visitors will generally speak English. Most municipal government services in New York City are available in English, Spanish, Chinese, and Russian. Because of a massive wave of immigration of Italians in the late 19th and early 20th century, Italian was once a major language — primarily the southern dialects (Napuletano, Siciliano, Calabrese, etc.). You can still hear them in Italian neighborhoods, along with Italian-American dialects of the younger generations. The more standardized Italian has been brought by 21st-century immigrants who tend to be young business professionals, as opposed to the much larger wave of working class southern Italian immigrants before them.

The upside to this linguistic confusion is that, while you can find a restaurant or other establishment for nearly every culture somewhere in Manhattan, catering to English-speaking tourists, more adventurous travelers may be able to find a more authentic experience for less money among an ethnic community somewhere in the outer boroughs.

Traditionally, English in New York City was spoken with distinctive accents, which differed according to ethnicity, neighborhood and social class (compare the Queens accent of Donald Trump with the Brooklyn accent of Bernie Sanders, both New Yorkers, as an example). Some of these accents are notable for being among the few non-rhotic American accents. You may still

encounter the traditional accents when talking to older working-class New Yorkers. Due to its large Ashkenazi Jewish population, many Yiddish terms have also made their way into local English slang. You may also hear the New York dialect of **African-American Vernacular English** (AAVE) being spoken among African-Americans, and a distinctive dialect known as **New York Latino English**, with noticeable influences from Puerto Rican and Dominican Spanish, is spoken by many Latinos. The long-established Jewish American and Italian-American communities have developed their own dialects that can still be heard throughout the city.

Get in

By plane

New York City (**NYC** ^{IATA} for all airports) is well connected by air with flights from almost every corner of the world. Three large airports, and several small ones, serve the region. John F. Kennedy International Airport (**JFK** ^{IATA}) and Newark Liberty International Airport (**EWB** ^{IATA}) are large international airports, while LaGuardia Airport (**LGA** ^{IATA}) is a busy domestic airport. All three airports are run by The Port Authority of New York and New Jersey (<https://www.panynj.gov/port-authority/en/index.html>).

Inter-airport transfers:

- **Bus/subway** - Connections between airports using the bus/subway/PATH trains are the cheapest option, but will require many transfers. Set aside a *minimum* of 2 hours for travel time.
- **Go Airlink Shuttle** (<https://www.goairlinkshuttle.com/>) - Shared van service to or from most of Manhattan.
- **Shared ride van services** - Some companies as ETS Airport Shuttle (<https://www.etsairportsuttle.com/>) and All County Express (<http://www.allcountyexpress.com/>) run very infrequent shared ride van service between airports.
- **Taxis** - the fastest option when changing airports. A taxi between JFK and LGA will cost about \$25–29 and should take 30 minutes. A taxi between LGA and EWR will cost about \$78 + tolls and should take 60–75 minutes. A taxi between JFK and EWR will cost about \$85 + tolls and should take 60–75 minutes.



Note: Taxi scammers

Scammers outside of the arrivals terminals at JFK will offer their services, claiming to be Uber drivers and that their original fare cancelled their ride. In many cases they will show the Uber logo either on a sign or on a smartphone.

Under no circumstances should you accept such offers! These people are not Uber drivers and many of them are not even licensed taxi drivers. These scammers will charge several times the rate into Manhattan, and add extras, such as “tax” and “tip.” In some cases, drivers have charged as much as \$1,300 for the trip.

If somebody like this approaches you, simply and firmly say “No.” Do not let them touch any of your luggage and do not allow them to intimidate you in any way. Do not hesitate to call the police on 911 if the scammers persist. The authorities will always back you in such incidents, despite the scammer’s threats of possible arrest or deportation.

(Information last updated 05 Sep 2025)

John F. Kennedy International Airport

Main article: [John F. Kennedy International Airport](#)

1 John F. Kennedy International Airport (JFK^{IATA}). New York's main airport and a major hub for American, Delta, and JetBlue, as well as other domestic and international airlines. If you are arriving into New York by plane from overseas, it is likely that JFK will be your point of entry. (updated Sep 2018 |)

If you arrive at this airport from overseas, be prepared to wait in line at Customs & Border Protection, often over an hour if you are not a permanent resident of the United States. As cellphones are not allowed in waiting lines, you may want to bring a book or other non-digital entertainment. If you are departing from this airport, beware that it's a huge and *congested* airport with six terminals. Make sure you know what terminal you're leaving from before you get to the airport, and it's recommended that you arrive 2 hours before domestic flights and 3 hours before international ones, to check in and pass through security without a huge increase in blood pressure and/or a last minute dash worthy of the Olympics, but without any of the medals.

If you're going to Manhattan, you can get there by **taxi** for a flat fare of \$70, **bus/subway** for \$2.90, or the **JFK AirTrain** — a 24-hr people mover system that takes passengers to the nearby **Jamaica** subway and **LIRR** stations for \$8.50. From Jamaica you can take NYC subway lines E, J or Z further into Brooklyn, Queens and onward to the island of Manhattan, with travel time being between 50 and 60 minutes to Penn Station in Midtown Manhattan. A faster option for those in the know is the **Long Island Rail Road (LIRR)**; these commuter trains can whisk you from Jamaica to Penn Station in roughly 20-25 minutes. Jamaica is a *major* hub for LIRR train services — only use this option if you are sure of what you're doing. You don't want to get on the wrong train and end up far from your destination. To add insult to injury, unforgiving conductors on the LIRR will charge you on the spot for incorrect tickets. Best to use this option once you have fully done your research or consulted with a local. LIRR trains are extremely crowded both toward and away from New York City during rush hours.

Traffic can be horrendous at all hours, in all directions. If you are driving or taking a taxi to or from JFK, leave yourself plenty of time to get to or from the airport.



AirTrain JFK passes by the iconic TWA Flight Center, the Eero Saarinen-designed head house of Terminal 5 at [John F. Kennedy International Airport](#)

Newark Liberty International Airport

Main article: Newark Liberty International Airport

2 Newark Liberty International Airport (EWR^{IATA}). In the state of New Jersey, west of Manhattan, serves as New York's second major international airport, New Jersey's primary airport, and a major hub for United Airlines. (updated Jun 2025 |)

You can get into New York City by **taxi** for \$50-70. Other taxi companies that run cabs to different destinations are also available from the airport. For a cheaper option, take the **train**: the NJ Transit commuter rail to New York Penn Station takes about 30 minutes and costs \$16.80 each way.

New Jersey Transit Bus #62 and other NJT Buses (<http://mybusnow.njtransit.com/bustime/wireless/html/selectdirection.jsp?route=62>) — The most inexpensive option, New Jersey Transit #62 bus runs from in front of all 3 airport terminals to Newark Penn Station (one-way fare \$1.80; exact change only; 25 min). From there, you may take a PATH subway train (\$3) either to World Trade Center station in lower Manhattan (25 min), or, to Journal Square, where you can transfer to the Journal Square-33rd St train across the platform, which runs to the following stops along 6th Ave: Christopher St in Greenwich Village, 9th St, 14th St, 23rd St, and 33rd St. Plan on 90 minutes including waiting times. The #62 Bus operates 24/7 between Elizabeth and Newark Penn Station, including holidays. Service generally runs every 10-15 minutes weekdays, 15-20 minutes Saturdays, and 20-30 minutes Sundays, with overnight service every 30 minutes.

The **AirTrain Newark** (<https://www.newarkairport.com/to-from-airport/air-train>) is easily accessed from the airport terminals via elevator/escalators and runs 24 hours to Newark Airport Rail Station, 10 min away, however, there's an \$8.50 fee when exiting/entering to the Newark Airport Station (the \$8.50 fee is included in the \$16.80 NJ Transit train ticket). From here you can take a NJ Transit train (30-min ride, every 15-30 min) to New York Penn Station (34th St & 8th Ave in Manhattan) or Amtrak train to other destinations along the east coast. Amtrak also runs trains to Manhattan, but they cost \$20-30. NJ Transit tickets are not valid on Amtrak trains. NJ Transit trains stop at both Newark Penn Station and New York Penn Station, so if your destination is Manhattan, stay on till you reach New York Penn Station.

Newark Airport's station along the Northeast Corridor gives it a major advantage over JFK and LGA, as long-distance **Amtrak** trains coming from as far south as Virginia, as far north as Massachusetts, and as far west as Harrisburg also stop at the station.

LaGuardia Airport

Main article: LaGuardia Airport

3 LaGuardia Airport (LGA^{IATA}). The smallest of the New York Metropolitan Area's three major airports, but also the closest to Midtown Manhattan. Almost all direct flights to LGA are from destinations within 1,500 miles. Most flights are domestic; however, there are international



The advantage of arriving at Newark is the direct access to a railway station served by fast trains not only to New York City but also to the whole Northeast corridor of the United States.

flights from Canada, Aruba, the Bahamas and Bermuda. The *Art Deco Marine Air Terminal* is one of the oldest airport terminals that is still in use in the world. LaGuardia used to be a dump, but the airport was completely rebuilt in the early 2020s, and it is now quite pleasant.

LaGuardia does not have a direct rail or subway connection to the rest of the city. Your best bet for reaching Manhattan is to take a taxi or use a rideshare app. Most taxi or rideshare fares to Midtown Manhattan from LaGuardia will average \$40-45 before tip. Trips via the Queens-Midtown Tunnel or RFK Bridge will incur a toll in addition to the fare. Traffic between Manhattan and LaGuardia can be awful during rush hours but generally is not a big issue outside of peak commuting times. If you feel comfortable using public transportation, two MTA Select Bus Service routes serve the airport. These buses can be very crowded at times but they do include luggage racks and operate 24 hours a day with a fair degree of frequency. The **M60-SBS** can take you to the area of Upper Manhattan around Columbia University via the Astoria neighborhood of Queens and 125th Street in Harlem. The **Q70-SBS LaGuardia Link** provides a connection to busy public transit hubs in the Woodside and Jackson Heights neighborhoods of Queens, where you can then connect onward to multiple subway, LIRR and bus lines. As of late 2022, riding the Q70 is free of charge. The M60 costs the standard bus fare of \$2.90 per passenger.



LaGuardia Airport in Queens was built as a seaplane harbor, and the Marine Air Terminal still stands, serving Delta (land-bound) flights

Westchester County Airport

- **Westchester County Airport** (<https://airport.westchestergov.com/>) (**HPN**^{IATA}) is 25 miles northeast of midtown Manhattan near the city of White Plains and is served by American, Cape Air, Delta, JetBlue, and United, mostly for flights on the East Coast. To travel between the city and HPN:
 - **Bee-Line Bus #12** (<https://transportation.westchestergov.com/timetables-and-map-s>) (fare \$2.75; ☎ +1-914-813-7777 for details) operates service to the White Plains Metro-North station. From there, you can take a Metro-North train (\$9.75 off-peak and \$12.75 peak) to any of various points in the Bronx, or 125th St/Park Ave and Grand Central Terminal in Manhattan. Trains run roughly every half hour for most of the day and take approximately 40 minutes to an hour.

Long Island MacArthur Airport

- **Long Island MacArthur Airport** (<http://www.macarthurairport.com/>) (Islip Airport) (**ISP**^{IATA}) is 45 miles east of midtown Manhattan in Ronkonkoma in the Town of Islip on Long Island. The airport is served by Southwest Airlines, a major discount carrier. To travel between ISP and the city:
 - **A shuttle bus** (10 minutes, \$5) operates between ISP and the Ronkonkoma Long Island Railroad station. From there, you can take a train to Penn Station in Manhattan. (1.5

hours, \$12.75 off-peak hours or \$17.50 peak hours). The Long Island Railroad offers a discount package for MacArthur Airport travelers (<https://away.mta.info/deals/macarthur-airport-isp-take-long-island-rail-road-and-relax-2023/>).

- **Hampton Jitney** (<https://reservations.hamptonjitney.com/>) operates bus services from Ronkonkoma to Manhattan costing \$40-47; the bus stop is a short cab ride away from ISP.
- **SCT 6 bus** (<https://sctbus.org/Route-6>) operates from the airport to Central Islip Station for \$2.25. However, it isn't coordinated with the train schedule like the shuttle.

Stewart International Airport

- **Stewart International Airport** (<https://www.swfny.com/>) (**SWF** ^{IATA}) is 75 miles north of midtown Manhattan, near Newburgh. It mainly serves flights from Florida. To travel between the city and SWF:
 - A shuttle bus (<https://leprechaunlines.com/stewart-newburgh-beacon-shuttle/>) (\$1, 40 minutes, M-F only) connects SWF with the Beacon Metro-North Railroad Station. From there, you can take a train into Grand Central Terminal in Manhattan (\$17.50 off-peak, \$23 peak, approximately 90 minutes).
 - Shortline (<https://web.coachusa.com/info/shortline/ss.stewartairportexpress.asp?nt=1>) operates bus service (\$20, 90 minutes) between the airport and the Port Authority Bus Terminal in Manhattan. Buses are timed based on arrivals and departures of Norwegian Airlines flights.

Trenton-Mercer Airport

- **Trenton-Mercer Airport** (<http://www.mercercounty.org/departments/transportation-and-infrastructure/trenton-merc-airport>) (**TTN** ^{IATA}) is 63 miles southwest of Midtown Manhattan and offers limited commercial service on Frontier Airlines. Passengers flying into Trenton can reach Manhattan by taking a taxi to the Trenton train station and then taking the New Jersey Transit Northeast Corridor Line or Amtrak to Penn Station.
- **Teterboro Airport** (<https://www.panynj.gov/airports/en/teterboro.html>) (**TEB** ^{IATA}) is the most popular choice for general aviation and business jet travelers out of New York City. Air taxi and air charter companies fly a variety of private charter aircraft and jets, from charter luxury Gulfstream's down to economical piston twins for small groups and individuals.

By train

See also: [Rail travel in the United States](#)

Amtrak

 **Amtrak** (<https://www.amtrak.com/>), ☎ +1 215-856-7924, toll-free: +1-800-872-7245. (updated Dec 2020 |) Amtrak operates to **4 Moynihan Train Hall at Penn Station** (<https://www.amtrak.com/stations/nyp>) (Amtrak code NYP), 351 West 31st Street (*directly under Madison Square Garden, between 31st and 33rd St, and between 8th and 9th Ave*). (updated Oct 2023 |) Popular trains leaving during rush hours can fill up quickly; it is a good idea to make reservations [online](https://www.amtrak.com/) (<https://www.amtrak.com/>), or via phone, and pick up your ticket using a credit card or your confirmation number at one of the electronic kiosks throughout the station. On some of the non-business routes, for example New York to Montreal, Amtrak takes more time and costs more money than taking the bus or renting a car. Check and compare schedules and prices before booking.

Amtrak's routes to Moynihan Train Hall at Penn Station include:

- **Acela** (<https://www.amtrak.com/acela-express-train>) operates multiple times daily between Boston and Washington, D.C. with stops in Westwood, Providence, New Haven, Stamford, New York City, Newark, Philadelphia, Wilmington, and Baltimore. The train provides up to 150 mph (240 km/h) intercity service between major points along the east coast. Travel time to New York City from Boston is 3.75 hours, from Providence is 3.25 hours, from Philadelphia is 1.25 hours, from Baltimore is 2.25 hours, and from Washington D.C. is 3 hours.



The interior of the Moynihan Train Hall at Penn Station

- **Adirondack** (<https://www.amtrak.com/adirondack-train>) operates daily between Montreal and New York City including stops along the way in Saint-Lambert, Rouses Point, Plattsburgh, Westport, Ticonderoga, Saratoga Springs, Schenectady, Albany (Rensselaer), Hudson, Rhinecliff, Poughkeepsie, Croton-on-Hudson, and Yonkers. Travel time to New York City from Montreal is 11 hours.
- **Cardinal** (<https://www.amtrak.com/cardinal-train>) operates multiple times weekly between Chicago and New York City with stops in Dyer, Rensselaer, Lafayette, Crawfordsville, Indianapolis, Connersville, Cincinnati, Ashland, Huntington, Charleston, Hinton, White Sulphur Springs, Staunton, Charlottesville, Culpeper, Manassas, Alexandria, Washington, D.C., Baltimore, Wilmington, Philadelphia, Trenton, and Newark.
- **Carolinian** (<https://www.amtrak.com/carolinian-piedmont-train>) operates between Charlotte and New York City via Raleigh, Richmond, and Washington, D.C.
- **Crescent** (<https://www.amtrak.com/crescent-train>) operates between New Orleans and New York City via Birmingham, Atlanta, Charlotte, and Washington, D.C.
- **Empire Service** operates daily between Niagara Falls (New York) and New York City including stops in Buffalo, Buffalo (Depew), Rochester, Syracuse, Rome, Utica, Schenectady, Albany (Rensselaer), Hudson, Rhinecliff, Poughkeepsie, Croton-on-Hudson, and Yonkers. Additional daily trips operate between Albany (Rensselaer) and New York City. Travel time to New York City from Niagara Falls is 9 hours, from Buffalo is 8.5 hours, from Rochester is 7.25 hours, and from Albany (Rensselaer) is 2.75 hours.
- **Ethan Allen Express** (<https://www.amtrak.com/ethan-allen-express-train>) operates daily between Burlington and New York City including in Middlebury, Rutland, Saratoga Springs, Schenectady, Albany (Rensselaer), Hudson, Rhinecliff, Poughkeepsie, Croton-on-Hudson, and Yonkers.
- **Keystone** (<https://www.amtrak.com/keystone-service-train>) operates multiple times daily between Harrisburg and New York City with stops in Elizabethtown, Lancaster, Coatesville, Downingtown, Exton, Paoli, Ardmore, Philadelphia, Trenton, and Newark.
- **Lake Shore Limited** (<https://www.amtrak.com/lake-shore-limited-train>), operates daily between Chicago and Boston or New York City. It makes stops at most stations along the route, though it does not stop at some of the smallest stations. Trains consist of train cars from both branches between Chicago and Albany (Rensselaer). The trains split into separate branches between Albany (Rensselaer) and both Boston and New York City. Stops between Chicago and Albany (Rensselaer) include South Bend, Elkhart, Waterloo, Bryan, Toledo, Sandusky, Elyria, Cleveland, Erie, Buffalo (Depew), Rochester, Syracuse, Utica, and Schenectady. Stops between Albany (Rensselaer) and New York City include Rhinecliff, Poughkeepsie, and Croton-on-Hudson. Travel time to New York City from Chicago is 21.25 hours.

- **Maple Leaf** operates daily between Toronto and New York City, in partnership with VIA Rail Canada (<https://www.viarail.ca/>). Stops between Toronto and Niagara Falls (New York) include in Oakville, Burlington, Grimsby, St. Catharines, and Niagara Falls (Ontario). Stops between Niagara Falls (New York) and New York City are the same as those made by the Empire Service. Border crossing processing takes place in Niagara Falls, where passengers must detrain with their baggage. Train crew members are staffed by VIA Rail within Canada, and by Amtrak within the United States. Travel time to New York City from Toronto is 13 hours.
- **Northeast Regional** (<https://www.amtrak.com/northeast-regional-train>) operates daily between Boston, New York City, Philadelphia, Baltimore, Washington, D.C., and the many towns and cities in-between. Toward the east end of the route, some trips terminate at Springfield instead of Boston. Some services also continue south into Virginia towards Newport News, Roanoke and Norfolk on three separate branch routes from Alexandria. The services are similar to Acela, with somewhat inferior passenger car interiors, while being only marginally slower for much lower prices.
- **Palmetto** (<https://www.amtrak.com/silver-service-palmetto-train>) operates between Savannah and New York City.
- **Silver Meteor** (<https://www.amtrak.com/silver-service-palmetto-train>) operates between Miami and New York City via Savannah.
- **Silver Star** (<https://www.amtrak.com/silver-service-palmetto-train>) operates between Miami and New York City via Savannah.
- **Vermont** (<https://www.amtrak.com/vermonter-train>) operates daily between St. Albans and Washington, D.C. including stops in Essex Junction, Waterbury, Montpelier, White River Junction, Claremont, Bellows Falls, Brattleboro, Greenfield, Northampton, Holyoke, Springfield, Windsor Locks, Hartford, Meriden, New Haven, Bridgeport, Stamford, New York City, Newark, Trenton, Philadelphia, Wilmington, Baltimore, and New Carrollton.

Service from California, Oregon or Washington state takes about 4 days and requires a change of train in Chicago.

Amtrak's ClubAcela Lounge (<https://www.amtrak.com/station-lounges>), near the big security desk in Penn Station, offers complimentary drinks, wi-fi access, newspapers and magazines, and clean bathrooms. Access to the club is granted to travelers with sleeper tickets, First Class Acela tickets, or Amtrak GuestRewards SelectPlus membership.

Long Island Rail Road

 **Long Island Rail Road** (<https://new.mta.info/agency/long-island-rail-road>) (LIRR) operates between **Penn Station** (<https://moynihantrainhall.nyc/transportation/>), or **5 Grand Central Terminal** (<https://www.grandcentralterminal.com/transportation/>) in Manhattan or **6 Atlantic Terminal** (<http://web.mta.info/lirr/AlternateRoute/AtlanticTerminal.htm>) in Brooklyn, and points on Long Island. Stops within New York City include smaller stations as well as larger commuter hubs like Jamaica, Nostrand Avenue and Woodside. As a tourist, you will most likely not use the LIRR but for seasoned visitors, it can be a useful and relatively quick method for traveling between Penn Station and JFK Airport. Tickets can be purchased online or inside stations prior to boarding the train. Tickets are also available for purchase on the train but are significantly more expensive. The cost of the ticket varies based on the distance of the ride. The LIRR system is complex and *not* particularly tourist-friendly: trains can be extremely crowded at peak commuting hours and on weekend evenings headed into NYC (when they're packed with younger people heading to bars and clubs—in various states of inebriation). LIRR trains operate 24 hours a day, but services can be infrequent or suspended overnight or during holidays.

Metro-North Railroad

 **Metro-North Railroad** (<https://new.mta.info/agency/metro-north-railroad>)

d) operates between **7 Grand Central Terminal** (<https://www.grandcentralterminal.com/transportation/>) and points north and northeast of the city all the way to Connecticut. Trains also stop at Harlem station on 125th Street and Park Avenue in Manhattan. The New Haven line serves cities along the coast with branch lines to Danbury and Waterbury. The Hudson Line serves points along the Hudson River like Tarrytown, Croton-Harmon, Peekskill, and Cold Spring, and terminating at Poughkeepsie. The Harlem Line serves Westchester, Putnam, and Dutchess Counties

to White Plains, Brewster, and Southeast, the station that provides shuttle service to Wassaic. At New Haven, passengers may transfer to Amtrak or to the *Shore Line East* providing local service between New Haven and New London, Connecticut. Tickets can be purchased online or inside stations prior to boarding the train. Tickets are also available for purchase on the train but are significantly more expensive. The cost of the ticket varies based on the distance of the ride. The Metro-North Railroad is decidedly more calm and user-friendly compared to the LIRR, but trains can still be very crowded at peak hours going into or out of the city. Metro-North Railroad trains do not operate 24 hours a day.



The spectacular Grand Central Terminal at night. 
This station is the terminating point for all Metro-North service

NJ Transit

 **NJ Transit** (<https://www.njtransit.com/>) operates between **Penn Station** (<https://www.njtransit.com/dv-to/New%20York%20Penn%20Station>), or **8 Hoboken Terminal** (<https://www.nywaterway.com/hobokennjtransitterminalterminal.aspx>) in Hoboken, and points in New Jersey. It is the only commuter railroad in New York City that isn't owned or operated by the MTA. The Northeast Corridor Line goes to Princeton and Trenton. Services are also available for points along the Jersey Coast via the North Jersey Coast Line, and to north-central suburbs like Summit, Peapack-Gladstone, or Morristown via the Morris & Essex Line, which is divided into the Morristown Line and Gladstone Branch. It also serves the town of Montclair via the Montclair-Boonton Line with a transfer in **9 Secaucus Junction** (<https://www.njtransit.com/station/secaucus-junction-station>). Travelling via a PATH or ferry connection in Hoboken, it also serves points north of the city (in New Jersey and New York State west of the Hudson), via the Pascack Valley and Bergen/Main/Port Jervis Line. The Raritan Valley Line serves some western suburbs, and is accessed via a PATH connection in **10 Newark Penn Station** (<https://www.amtrak.com/stations/nwk>). Connecting service is available from Trenton to Philadelphia via SEPTA or to Camden (New Jersey) via RiverLINE. Connecting service to Newark Liberty International Airport is available from some Northeast corridor trains. Tickets can be purchased online or inside stations prior to boarding the train. Tickets are also available for purchase on the train but are significantly more expensive. The cost of the ticket varies based on the distance of the ride.

PATH

PATH (<http://www.panynj.gov/path/index.html>) (Port Authority Trans-Hudson) is a subway network connecting New York City to Hoboken, Jersey City, Newark, and various points along the Hudson River. Two lines pass under the Hudson and enter the city, one terminating at World Trade Center in downtown, and one terminating at 33rd Street in midtown (see map (<https://www.panynj.gov/path/en/schedules-maps.html>)). The station at 33rd Street is not connected to, nor part of, Penn Station.

TAPP (<https://www.tappandride.com>) is the contactless fare payment system for the PATH subway lines. The system allows passengers to pay by "tapping" one of the following to a reader:

- A contactless credit, debit or prepaid card, including American Express, Discover, JCB, Mastercard, UnionPay or Visa.
- A smart device equipped with Apple Pay, Google Pay or Samsung Pay.
- A TAPP card (TAPP cards do not work on the MTA network).

A standard fare for the subway is \$3. A half price fare is available for those 65 and over, or those with a covered disability. You must specify a card or device to receive the half price fare. A free fare is available for children up to three years old and up to 44 inches (112 cm) tall, when accompanied by a fare paying adult.

By boat

New York City has always been one of the world's most important passenger sea ports, and arriving by ocean liner or cruise ship remains an extraordinary and stylish method of arrival. In addition to passenger service on Cunard, many cruise ships start or end their voyages in New York City.

- **Cunard** (<https://www.cunard.com>) operates regularly scheduled passenger service between the Brooklyn Cruise Terminal and Southampton, United Kingdom as well as Hamburg, Germany aboard the **RMS Queen Mary 2**, the grandest, largest ocean liner ever built. The trip takes 6–7 days and costs \$800–6,000 depending on the cabin and season.
- More mundane arrivals can be had from New Jersey via **NY Waterway** and **SeaStreak**, two fast ferry services.

By bus

See also: [Long-distance bus travel in the United States](#)

Buses serve New Jersey, New York suburbs west of the Hudson River, and all cities along the east coast of the U.S. Some buses offer wi-fi, outlets and even business-class style luxury. The primary bus terminal is the **11 Port Authority Bus Terminal** (<https://www.panynj.gov/bus-terminals/en/port-authority.html>), 625 8th Ave (*Along 8th Ave between 40th & 42nd Sts, near Times Square*), ☎ +1 212-564-8484. 24/7. (updated Jan 2026 |)

The following bus companies serve New York City:

- **Academy Bus** (<https://www.academybus.com/Commuters/Commuters.aspx>), ☎ +1 201-420-7000, toll-free: +1-800-442-7272. Operates commuter services from Burlington, Mercer, Middlesex, Monmouth and Ocean Counties in New Jersey. Casino Express (<https://www.academybus.com/Casinos/Schedules.aspx>) service to/from Atlantic City and Mohegan Sun.

- **Akai LLC** (<https://akailc.com/>), Pandora Bus Station @ 19 Allen St, ☎ +1 205-585-3888, +1 678-908-1588. From several cities in Alabama and Georgia via Baltimore MD; Richmond VA; Charlotte NC; Greenville SC and Atlanta GA.
- **BestBus** (<https://www.bestbus.com/>), (Bus stop) 314 W 31st St (*btwn 8th and 9th Ave on the south side of the post office near Madison Square Garden and Penn Station*), ☎ +1 202-332-2691, toll-free: +1-888-888-3269. Service to Union Station and Dupont Circle in Washington DC; Silver Spring in Maryland; Manassas, Vienna, and Springfield in Virginia; and summer weekend service to Rehoboth Beach and Dewey Beach in Delaware. Buses offer free Wi-Fi, electrical outlets, and free water.
- **C & J** (<https://www.ridecj.com/>), Port Authority Bus Terminal @ 625 8th Ave. Service from Boston, and from smaller cities in New England such as Tewksbury, MA; Portsmouth, NH; and Ogunquit, ME
- **Coach USA** (<https://www.coachusa.com/>), Port Authority Bus Terminal @ 625 8th Ave. The parent company of Megabus (<https://us.megabus.com/>) offers commuter routes, university express, airport shuttles and casino shuttles to the Port Authority Bus Terminal from New Jersey.
- **Coach USA Shortline** (<https://www.coachusa.com/shortline/>), Port Authority Bus Terminal @ 625 8th Ave. Coach USA also operates the Shortline as a commuter bus from Rockland, Orange, and Sullivan Counties, NY; Bergen County, NJ; and Pike County, PA to Midtown, Downtown, the East Side, and Wall Street in Manhattan, and over longer distances from Monticello, Binghamton, Ithaca, Owego, Elmira, Corning, Alfred, etc.
- **Concord Coach Lines** (<https://concordcoachlines.com/>), (bus stop) 373 E 42nd St (*Transit bus stop (Rt M42 & X21) on E 42nd St between 1st & 2nd Ave, next to Tudor City Place Overpass (bridge).*), ☎ +1 603-228-3300, toll-free: +1-800-639-3317. Express bus from Portland, ME on one route and from Concord, NH via Nashua on another.
- **Eagle-Pandora** (<https://www.gotobus.com/pandora-bus/bus-routes/>). Service from many major cities on the East Coast.
- **Go Buses** (<https://www.gobuses.com/>), (bus stop) W 30th St btwn 9th & 10 Ave, opposite 450 W 30th St, toll-free: +1-855-888-7160. Boston, Cambridge, Newton, Providence, Hartford and New Haven to NYC on multiple route combinations. Washington DC & Alexandria to NYC and Vienna/Fairfax and Manassas to NYC. Mt Holly to NYC.
- **Greyhound Lines** (<http://www.greyhound.com>), Port Authority Bus Terminal @ 625 8th Ave, toll-free: +1-800-231-2222. Offers connections from across North America (40 states & 2 Canadian provinces) to the Port Authority Bus Terminal on 8th Avenue & 42nd Street. Wi-Fi, electrical outlets and the works on some buses. Travel time to New York City from Toronto is 12-13.25 hours, from Montreal is 7.5-9.5 hours, from Buffalo is 8-9 hours, from Washington, D.C. is 4.25-5.25 hours.
- **Flixbus** (<https://www.flixbus.com/bus/new-york-ny>). Connects Richmond to New York through Baltimore, Rockville & Washington DC and goes to New York from Boston. They also connect New York to Atlanta through Charlotte, Durham, Greensboro and Greenville. (updated Jul 2019 |)
- **Focus Travel Bus** (<https://www.gotobus.com/focus-travel-inc/>), ☎ +1 202-216-9222. Service from Philadelphia.
- **Fox Bus Lines** (<https://www.gotobus.com/fox-bus-inc-/>), (bus stops) 152 E Broadway and 6th Ave btwn 31st & 32nd St. From Schenectady and Albany, NY and from Philadelphia.
- **Fullington Trailways** (<https://susquehannabus.com/>). Travels across Pennsylvania from Williamsport PA to New York City via Allentown and Hazleton (updated Mar 2025 |)
- **Hampton Jitney** (<http://www.hamptonjitney.com/>), ☎ +1 631-283-4600. From various places in eastern Long Island to stops in Manhattan and Brooklyn.
- **Jet Bus** (<https://thejet.coach/>). Luxury bus service with motion-canceling technology that eliminates 90% of bumps and vibration. Service from Washington DC.
- **Lakeland Bus Lines** (<http://www.lakelandbus.com/>), Port Authority Bus Terminal @ 625 8th Ave, ☎ +1 973-366-0600. Commuter buses to NY Port Authority Bus Terminal from

northern New Jersey

- **Lucky Star** (<https://www.luckystarbus.com/>), (office) 145 Canal St (*Canal & Bowey in Chinatown Manhattan*). 6AM-11PM and at 2AM. Runs from Boston to their Chinatown office at least hourly 6AM-11PM and at 2AM. Wi-Fi provided on some buses.
- **Martz Bus** (<https://martzbus.com/>) (Martz Trailways), ☎ +1 570-821-3838. Martz offers commuter & intercity routes from Hackettstown, Panther Valley Mall, Atlantic City, Wilkes-Barre, Scranton, Stroudsburg, Poconos.
- **Megabus** (<https://us.megabus.com/>). Frequent service from Newark, DE; Georgia (Athens & Atlanta); Massachusetts (Amherst, Boston, Dartmouth); Hartford, CT; North Carolina; New Jersey; (upstate) New York, Ohio, Pennsylvania; Columbia, SC; Burlington, VT; Virginia, Washington D.C.; Chicago, IL and Toronto. Most buses arrive on the west side of 7th Avenue just south of 28th Street (*nearest subway station is 28th Street on the 1 line*) and depart from the south side of 34th Street between 11th and 12th Avenues, across the street from the Javits Center (*nearest subway station is 34th Street—Hudson Yards on the 7 line*). Services to Binghamton, New Brunswick, Princeton and Atlantic City arrive and depart at the Port Authority Bus Terminal on 8th Avenue & 42nd Street. They can also be in different locations from the above, depending on destination, so check with their website. Wi-Fi and electrical outlets available on each bus.
- **New Jersey Transit** (<https://www.njtransit.com/>), ☎ +1 973-275-5555. Operates service from destinations in New Jersey to Manhattan's Port Authority Bus Terminal on 8th Ave & 42nd St.
- **NY Tiger** (<http://www.nytiger.com/>), (office) 59 Canal St (*Corner of Canal & Orchard St in Chinatown Manhattan*), ☎ +1 212-625-9928, +1 917-299-5567, +1 757-717-1677. Daily bus services to New York from Norfolk, Virginia Beach, Hampton and Salisbury. There's a "NY Lion Bus" (<http://www.nylion.com/>) that runs the same route from the same station and can be affiliated.
- **Ocean Bus Lines** (<http://www.oceanbus.com/>), 3 Allen St; 3 Bowery St (Corner of Bowery & Division); and 194 Canal St (Btwn Mott & Mulberry St), ☎ +1 917-622-7696. Service from Buffalo via Liverpool (near Syracuse) and Rochester.
- **OurBus** (<https://ourbus.com/>), ☎ +1-844-800-6828. Operates service from Boston, Washington DC and from multiple cities in upstate New York, New Jersey, Virginia, and Pennsylvania. Various stops in NYC.
- **Panda NY Bus** (<https://www.pandanybus.com/>), (bus station) 19 Allen St, ☎ +1 917-420-5989. From Richmond via Philadelphia, Baltimore and Washington. From Richmond their buses continue towards Huntsville, Atlanta, Orlando, Nashville and points in between on multiple routes. They also have another route to Buffalo through Binghamton, Syracuse and Rochester in upstate New York. They also have another stop location at 127 E Broadway.
- **Pandora Bus** (<https://www.gotobus.com/pandora-bus/>) (Eagle Bus), 19 Allen St. From Atlanta, Augusta GA, Savannah GA, Orlando FL, Columbia SC and points in between via Raleigh NC on multiple routes.
- **Peter Pan** (<https://peterpanbus.com/>). Operates between cities in the Northeast U.S. (in Connecticut, Massachusetts, Maryland, Philadelphia, PA; Albany, NY; New Jersey, New Hampshire, Rhode Island and Washington, DC) and the Port Authority Bus Terminal on 8th Avenue & 42nd Street.
- **Starline Express** (<http://www.starlinebus.com/>), (bus station) 95 Canal St, ☎ +1-646-859-2288. From Tampa via Battleboro, Brunswick, Charleston, Fayetteville, Florence, Hardeeville, Jacksonville, Lumberton, Manning, Savannah, Wilson, Summerville, Rocky Mount, Orlando, St. George, Roanoke Rapids and Weldon.
- **Trailways** (<https://trailways.com/>), Port Authority Bus Terminal @ 625 8th Ave, ☎ +1 716-855-7533, toll-free: +1-800-776-7548. Largest intra-state bus operator serving New York State.
- **1 Tripper Bus** (<https://www.tripperbus.com/>), (Bus stop) 254 W 31st St (*NE corner of 31 St between 7th and 8th Ave, (outside of the Penn Station) closer to 8th Ave, the opposite side of*

Brother Jimmy's BBQ), toll-free: +1-877-826-3874. Travels from Bethesda, Maryland (4681 Willow Ln at the corner of Wisconsin Ave., opposite side of Panera Bread, the same side of Bethesda's Farm Women's Market.) and the Rosslyn Metrorail station in Arlington, Virginia (1901 N Moore St @ city bus stop at Moore & 19th Ave N). Power outlets on board. Select a Tripper Elite bus and receive luxury amenities and comfort including wider leather captain's chair reclined seating offering more leg room.

- **Uptown Vans (<https://www.uptownvans.com/>)**, info@uptownvans.com (<mailto:info@uptownvans.com>). Offers routes to Upper Manhattan from Scranton, Wilkes-Barre, Hazleton, Allentown, Reading, Philadelphia, Lancaster, York, Harrisburg, Hartford, Springfield, Worcester, Providence, Boston, Lowell, Lawrence, and Lynn. (updated Mar 2025 |)
- **Vamoose (<https://www.vamoosebus.com/>)**, (Bus stop) NW corner of W 30th St & 7th Ave across from Bravo Pizza, ☎ +1-212-695-6766, +1-301-718-0036. Travels from Bethesda, MD; Arlington, VA; & Lorton, VA.
- **Washington Deluxe (<https://www.washny.com>)**, (bus stop) Pig n' Whistle Pub @ 202 W 36th St (btwn 7th & 8th Ave); Chinatown @ 72 Allen St (btwn Grand & Broome St); Brooklyn @ 40 Empire Blvd (btwn Flatbush & Washington Ave, in front of Popeye's), toll-free: +1-866-287-6932. Service from Washington DC. Wi-Fi. From Washington DC (\$21) some to Brooklyn.

By car

While most people would advise against entering New York City by car (see the "Get around" section below), it is accessible by a number of highways:

From New Jersey, there are three Hudson River crossings: The George Washington Bridge (on I-95, US 1 and US 9) in Fort Lee drops you off in Upper Manhattan, the Lincoln Tunnel (on NJ Route 495) in Weehawken will bring you to Midtown Manhattan, and the Holland Tunnel (on I-78) in Jersey City leaves you in lower Manhattan. Depending on where you are heading to in New York City and the time of day, you'll want to take advantage of the different crossings, but if you have the time and are looking for the most scenic of the three, take the George Washington Bridge's upper level for spectacular views of New York City; Hudson County, New Jersey; and the Hudson River. If you are heading to Staten Island, Queens or Brooklyn you can also take the Goethals Bridge (on I-278) in Elizabeth; the highway cuts across Staten Island and continues over the Verrazzano-Narrows Bridge to Brooklyn. The other routes into Staten Island from NJ are the Outerbridge Crossing in Perth Amboy, which puts you in Tottenville near the southern tip of the island, and the Bayonne Bridge, which leaves you in extreme northern Staten Island.

From Upstate New York, you can take one of several highways into the Bronx, including the New York State Thruway, which becomes the Major Deegan Expressway in the Bronx (both roads are I-87). The Connecticut Turnpike/New England Thruway (I-95) and the Merritt Parkway/Hutchinson River Parkway are good routes from Connecticut and areas of Westchester County near the Long Island Sound. From Long Island you can take the Long Island Expressway (I-495) or the Northern State Parkway/Grand Central Parkway for access to Queens, the Bronx and Manhattan. The Southern State and Belt Parkways are useful for Queens, Brooklyn, and Staten Island.

Get around

Public transit

Fares

OMNY (<https://omny.info>) is the contactless fare payment system for the MTA subway and bus lines. The system allows passengers to pay by "tapping" one of the following to a reader:

- A contactless credit, debit or prepaid card, including American Express, Discover, JCB, Mastercard, UnionPay or Visa.
- A smart device equipped with Apple Pay, Google Pay or Samsung Pay.
- An OMNY card (OMNY cards do not work on the PATH network).

A standard fare for the subway and/or local bus is \$3. A standard fare for the express bus is \$7.25. A half price fare is available for those 65 and over, or those with a covered disability. You must specify a card or device to receive the half price fare. A free fare is available for children up to three years old and up to 44 inches (112 cm) tall, when accompanied by a fare paying adult.

A fare cap applies during any 7-day period. It's \$35 when using the subway and/or local bus. It's \$67 when using the express bus. A half price fare cap is available for those 65 and over, or those with a covered disability. You must use the same card or device to reach the fare cap. You must also specify a card or device to receive the half price fare cap.

The system offers free transfers. You can transfer from subway to subway as often as you like, provided that you do not exit the subway system by leaving through a fare gate. Many subway connections are possible in this way, by using in-station connections between the various lines. Indeed, the Guinness Book of World Records tracks the fastest times that



NYC Subway car interior



NYC Subway car exterior



The New York City Subway is the fastest and most convenient way to get around the city. However, it can get really, really crowded, especially during rush hour.



people have tried to ride every single New York City subway train line on a single fare. Some have spent over 24 consecutive hours riding the subway! Just remember that if you leave the subway and re-enter, you will be charged a second fare.

The following transfers are free regardless if you leave the subway and re-enter:

- Between Lexington Avenue-59th Street on the 4, 5, 6, N, R, and W and Lexington Avenue-63rd Street on the M (weekdays) F (nights and Weekends) and Q
- Between the Livonia Avenue on the L and Junius Street on the 3 and 4

The following transfers are free during a two-hour window:

- From subway to local bus
- From local bus to subway
- From local bus to local bus, but not to any bus on the same route as the first
- From express bus to subway
- From express bus to local bus
- From express bus to express bus, but not to any bus on the same route as the first

The system will place a hold on your payment method for each tap you make. It might seem like you are being charged for every tap, but the system tabulates all taps, sees when and where you should be granted transfers and then makes a once-per-business-day charge to your payment method of choice at the correct rate. A simple round trip that requires a bus to subway transfer might look like you will be charged \$12 but only \$6 will be charged at the end of the day.

OMNY is also accepted on the AirTrain JFK and the Roosevelt Island Tramway. A standard fare for the AirTrain JFK is \$8.50. A standard fare for the Roosevelt Island Tramway is \$3.

TAPP (<https://www.tappandride.com>) is the contactless fare payment system for the PATH subway lines. The system allows passengers to pay by "tapping" one of the following to a reader:

- A contactless credit, debit or prepaid card, including American Express, Discover, JCB, Mastercard, UnionPay or Visa.
- A smart device equipped with Apple Pay, Google Pay or Samsung Pay.
- A TAPP card (TAPP cards do not work on the MTA network).

By subway

Despite a reputation for being dirty, the subway is the fastest way to travel around the city, operating 24 hours a day 7 days a week. The much-feared subway crimes of the 1970s and 1980s are for the most part a thing of the past, and it is usually completely safe. Just remember to use common sense when traveling late at night alone. Try to use heavily-traveled stations, remain visible to other people, and don't display items of value publicly. While violent crime is rare, petty crime - especially theft of iPhones and other expensive electronics - is very frequent, so be aware when using your phone on the train.

Subway basics

- **Overhead signage** next to each track indicates the trains that stop at that particular track and the direction they are heading. In addition, the trains are marked by signage that indicates their route. Subway stations are ventilated to the street, so they can be quite cold in the winter. In summertime, the stations can be much warmer than the outside temperature.

The trains



Map of the New York City Subway and Staten Island Railway

themselves are air-conditioned and usually quite comfortable, but keep the temperature of stations in mind when planning your trip.

- Some stations, especially local-only ones, have **entrances** which provide access to trains headed in one direction, not both. Read the signage outside the entrance to know which direction the train heads toward. If it heads in the opposite direction of where you need to go, enter across the street.
- Despite the name, about 40% of the system is outdoors, all of which is in the outer boroughs save for the 1 in Upper Manhattan. All lines except the C, E, R, and 42nd Street shuttle have at least one outdoor station. These stations can be on elevated structures above the streets, in open cuttings (basically a tunnel without a roof), or just on ground level.
- Some trains are **express**, meaning that they skip local stations to provide faster service. Wherever there is an express train, there is also a **local** train

"Left luggage"

There are very few left luggage, storage lockers, or coat-check service at *any* New York train station. This includes Penn Station and Grand Central Terminal; however the Amtrak checked and left luggage point at Penn Station is still operating, but only for ticketed passengers. There are left luggage services in the Arrivals area of Terminals 1 and 4 at **JFK Airport**. The left luggage office in Terminal 4 is open 24 hours. **Schwartz Travel & Storage**, with three locations in

that makes all stops. Local and express trains often use different tracks, so be sure to board the correct train. For example, the 2 and 3 are the express trains for the Broadway–7th Avenue Line between 96th Street and Chambers Street in Manhattan, while the 1 runs local alongside them. Some express trains run local or do not run at all late at night, and there are some lines in which there is an express train only during rush hours, in one direction. These trains either use a diamond-shaped icon instead of a circle-shaped one or are the Z train.

Midtown Manhattan close to Penn Station is one of several left luggage services. The price per day is \$7-10 per bag. Most left luggage services include a lounge where users can watch TV and use the Wi-Fi services. Some hotels will store luggage for customers.

- During weekends and late nights, certain trains do not operate or operate on a **limited schedule or route**, many express trains make local stops, and some subway entrances are closed. Detailed information is available on the [MTA website \(http://www.mta.info\)](http://www.mta.info). Additionally, maintenance work is usually concentrated on weekends and overnight. Notices of maintenance are posted at stations and on the MTA website (<https://www.mta.info/>), so check online to avoid unpleasant surprises. Remember, if you do feel confused, ask for help. Construction-related service changes confuse many New Yorkers, so the best person to ask is a subway employee. The entire subway system is massive and interconnected, so do not fear — there will almost always be another way to get to your destination without spending hours on the train.
- A free **subway map** can be found online (<http://web.mta.info/maps/submap.html>), or obtained at staffed station booths. Station agents can also assist you with directions, although agents may not always be easy to find. Free bus system maps for each borough, which are also available on the MTA website and from most bus drivers and some subway station booths, double as fairly good street maps that show the exact location of every subway station. Additionally, for convenience, subway maps are displayed in every station and on every train.
- If you accidentally skip your destination, *don't panic*. Get off at the next station and *do not go out onto the street* to try to get to the opposite platform. Doing so will not count as a transfer and you will be charged for the OMNY tap. Instead, navigate underground to get to the other platform, following the signs. As mentioned above, some stations do not have passage between the platforms; in this case, ask a subway employee which station ahead does let you cross over, wait for the next train there, then cross over. Tell them which station you are trying to get to, because they may suggest a different subway line that can get you there faster; since you are coming back, it does not matter which line you take if you transfer back to your original line.
- If you see an empty car despite the fact that the rest of the train is crowded, you should avoid riding in that car. This usually means that there is a strong bad smell in that car. If the crew have been made aware, the doors on the car might be locked.
- If you don't feel completely safe, such as if you are traveling very late at night, look for the **black-and-white striped bar** mounted on the wall or hanging from the ceiling of the station which marks the location of the conductor's car, and board there. Generally, every car will be equally safe, but you may feel better with another pair of eyes nearby.

Subway routes

- Subway lines are not referred to by color. Instead, each route is identified by either a letter or a number. The colors refer to the set of tracks used by the route, and older New Yorkers in particular also often identify routes by the line they travel on, as shown below. Some longtime residents might even still use the names of the vintage companies that built the system, their names still visible in vintage signage. It is possible for a service to be diverted to a different route, especially during weekends and maintenance periods. Numbered routes use narrower train cars than lettered routes.

- The Seventh Avenue Line (**1 2 3**) serves Broadway above 42nd Street and Seventh Avenue below 42nd Street, and is useful to get to the West Village, Chelsea, and Tribeca neighborhoods as well as the Staten Island or Ellis Island/Statue of Liberty ferries (1 to South Ferry station) and Columbia University (1 to 116th Street station). In Manhattan, the 1 train is local, while the 2 and 3 trains are express. Late nights, the 1 and 2 run local, while the 3 is an express turning around at 34th Street-Penn station to head back to Harlem.
- The Lexington Avenue Line trains (**4 5 6**) were essentially the only trains on the East Side above 23 Street until the construction of the Q Second Avenue Subway (see below). Useful to get to the Metropolitan Museum of Art (4, 5, or 6 to 86th Street station or 6 to 77th Street station), Guggenheim Museum (4, 5, or 6 to 86th Street station), and other East Side museums. Also useful to get to the Statue of Liberty (4 or 5 to Bowling Green station), Chinatown (6 to Canal Street station), and the Stock Exchange (4 or 5 to Wall Street station). The 4 also runs uptown through Spanish Harlem to 161 Street–Yankee Stadium and other destinations in the Bronx. In Manhattan, the 4 and 5 trains are express, and the 6 train is local. At night, the 5 is limited to a shuttle in the Bronx and the 4 and 6 share the local tracks.
- The Flushing Line (**7**), dubbed the "International Express", runs crosstown along 42nd Street (making a good late-night alternative to the upstairs Shuttle – see below) and out to Queens, making stops in Filipino, South Asian, Hispanic, and Chinese/Korean neighborhoods. The penultimate stop on the line serves Citi Field and the USTA Billie Jean King Tennis Center. The 7 train is local, as it is the only route that operates on that line; however, it does offer express service during rush hours, toward Manhattan in the morning and toward Flushing in the afternoon.
- The Eighth Avenue Line (**A C E**) serves Eighth Avenue/Central Park West between 14th and 116th Streets, then St. Nicholas Av., Broadway, and Ft. Washington Av. starting at 125th St. in Harlem. Between 50th and 59th streets, the E branches off to Queens, and the B and D trains join the A and C trains for the journey uptown along Central Park West (the B and C make local stops). This section is useful to get to the Museum of Natural History (B or C to 81st Street station), and the Cloisters Museum (A to 190th Street station). Take an uptown E train or Rockaway-bound downtown A train for access to JFK Airport. In Manhattan, except late nights, the A train is express, while the C and E trains are local. However, the E is the fastest express train in Queens, very useful for access to Jamaica and JFK if you are coming from Midtown. At night, the C does not run at all, and the A makes all stops between Upper Manhattan and Rockaway (and yes, if you're wondering, it is a *VERY* long trip)
- The Sixth Avenue Line (**B D F F M**) runs on 6th Avenue from West 4th Street to 47th–50th Streets, and is useful for accessing the New York Public Library Main Branch (42nd Street station), Rockefeller Center, Radio City Music Hall, and St. Patrick's Cathedral (47th–50th Sts. station). In Manhattan, the D is express, the B is local above 59th St. (and does not run on weekends), and the F and M trains are local.
 - Going downtown below West Fourth Street, these trains go on their own separate ways. The D goes down 4th Avenue in Brooklyn to Coney Island. The F goes to Coney Island on its own route closer to Prospect Park. The B goes express in Brooklyn and ends at Brighton Beach alongside the Q train, which also goes to Coney Island. The M goes east alongside the Nassau Street line (see below), but then branches again up Myrtle Avenue to Middle Village in Queens.
 - Going uptown, the B and D trains branch west and join the A and C trains (see above). They branch again toward the Bronx after 145th Street (which is the way to get to the 161 St–Yankee Stadium stop). The F train branches east and joins the E along 53rd street for the Museum of Modern Art (5 Av/53 St station), then heads off to Queens. The M train makes one more 6th Avenue stop at 57th Street before turning east to Queens, making a stop at Roosevelt Island and joining the E, F, and R trains. During late nights and weekends, the M does not serve Midtown Manhattan nor northern Queens, so the F runs via Roosevelt Island and the E goes it alone on 53rd street.
- The Nassau Street Line (**J Z**) starts at Broad Street and goes along Nassau Street in Lower Manhattan before making stops along Broadway and Fulton Street in Brooklyn (not Broadway in Manhattan) and terminating in the Jamaica area of Queens. It's useful if you are

transferring from a train that doesn't serve Lower Manhattan, but also if you are going to parts of Brooklyn or Queens. The J train is mostly local, though it will run express in the peak direction between Marcy Avenue and Myrtle Avenue, and the Z train is a skip-stop train that only operates during rush hour.

- The Broadway Line (**N Q R W**) runs down Broadway below 42nd Street and on Seventh Avenue and 59th Street above Times Square. The Broadway Line trains are useful for accessing Chinatown (Canal St), SoHo/NoHo (Prince St), NYU area (8th St), Union Square (14th St), the Empire State Building (34th St), Times Square (42nd St), Carnegie Hall (57th St–7th Av station), Central Park (57th St–7th Av and 5th Av/59th St stations) and the southern end of the Upper East Side (5th Av/59th St and Lexington Av/59th St stations). The Q train goes further uptown through the Upper East Side via the new Second Avenue Line, while the N and W trains head out to Astoria, Queens. The R also goes up past Astoria to Jackson Heights and beyond, and is joined by the W down through the Financial District and South Ferry (Whitehall St). Like the D and F trains, the N and Q trains also provide service to Coney Island via their own separate routes: The N goes solo, and the Q runs alongside the B (see above). In Manhattan, the N and Q trains are express and the R and W trains are local. However, the W train only operates on weekdays. The N usually runs local late nights, and sometimes the Q does, too.
- The Canarsie Line (**L**) is a local line that runs crosstown along 14th Street in Manhattan, then through Williamsburg and Bushwick and eventually to Canarsie in Brooklyn.
- The Crosstown Line (**G**) is a local line that runs along most of Western Brooklyn and into Long Island City in Queens. At no point on its route does it stop in Manhattan.
- There are three Shuttles (**S**) in the system. The 42nd Street Shuttle stops only at Times Square on the West Side and Grand Central Terminal on the East Side. The Franklin Avenue Shuttle in Brooklyn makes four stops – at Fulton Street (transfer to C), Park Place, Botanical Gardens (transfer to 2, 3, 4, and 5), and Prospect Park (transfer to B and Q). The Rockaway Park Shuttle connects with the A train at Broad Channel before branching off toward Beach–116th Street on the Rockaway Peninsula in Queens.

Staten Island Railway (<https://new.mta.info/agency/staten-island-railway>) (SIR) is a rapid transit line that serves Staten Island along the East Shore from St. George to Tottenville. SIR is owned and operated by the MTA. SIR accepts OMNY contactless fare payments at the Tompkinsville and St. George stations; the rest of the line is free. SIR timetables are usually coordinated with those of the Staten Island Ferry.

PATH (<https://www.panynj.gov/path/en/index.html>) (Port Authority Trans-Hudson) is a rapid transit network providing service between urban New Jersey and Manhattan across two branches, one connecting the city of Newark with the World Trade Center and one connecting the smaller enclaves of Hoboken and Jersey City with the Herald Square area of Midtown Manhattan. PATH is neither owned nor operated by the MTA. PATH accepts TAPP contactless fare payments. PATH operates 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, with 5–10 minute frequencies during the day and 30 minute frequencies during the night. PATH *can* be used to travel within Manhattan along a segment running under Sixth Avenue, although realistically there's no reason to use this service unless the Sixth Avenue subway line (**B D F F M**) is severely delayed or disrupted. PATH stations are cramped and dusty; expect extremely crowded conditions during rush hours.

By train

Trains are mostly used for traveling between the city and its suburbs. Purchasing a ticket onboard is significantly more expensive than purchasing a ticket online or in stations beforehand. Trains do not accept OMNY or TAPP contactless fare payments.

Long Island Rail Road (<https://new.mta.info/agency/long-island-rail-road>) (LIRR) provides services from Penn Station, Grand Central, Atlantic Terminal, and Long Island City to Queens and the eastern suburbs of the city. LIRR is owned and operated by the MTA. The Port Washington Branch goes to Northeast Queens which, aside from Flushing and Citi Field, is not served by the subway system. The Main Line, which contains most of the branches to the different parts of Long Island, goes to Southeastern Queens, including Jamaica, Laurelton, and Rosedale. The Atlantic Branch, which ends in Downtown Brooklyn, goes to East New York and Bedford-Stuyvesant, both in Brooklyn. This branch is not accessible from Manhattan, however. LIRR is also the fastest way to get from JFK to Manhattan, Brooklyn, or Queens, and also runs to many popular getaways in Long Island, such as Long Beach, Port Jefferson, and Montauk. LIRR has a somewhat deserved reputation for poor on-time performance, however this is more of a problem in the farther eastern reaches of the railroad and not so much a problem in New York City and its immediate suburbs.

Metro-North Railroad (<https://new.mta.info/agency/metro-north-railroad>) provides services from Grand Central to The Bronx and the northern suburbs of the city. Metro-North Railroad is owned and operated by the MTA. The Hudson Line covers several parts of the Western Bronx, while the Harlem Line goes through the Central Bronx — an area with no subway service. It is the best way to get to Arthur Avenue and the New York Botanic Gardens. The Hudson and Harlem Lines are also your gateway to Westchester County and beyond, with the Hudson Line running all the way to Poughkeepsie. The New Haven Line runs to Connecticut, terminating in New Haven.

NJ Transit (<https://www.njtransit.com>) only provides services from Penn Station to New Jersey. NJ Transit is neither owned nor operated by the MTA.

By bus

Even in Manhattan, with its dense subway network, buses can often be the best way of making a crosstown (i.e. east-west) journey — for example, crossing Central Park to go from the Metropolitan Museum of Art to the Museum of Natural History. And outside peak hours, a ride by bus from the tip of Lower Manhattan at Battery Park to Midtown is a good and cheap way of taking in the sights.

Bus basics

- Bus lines are identified by letters followed by numbers. The letters indicate the borough in which the line mostly operates (M=Manhattan; Bx=Bronx; B=Brooklyn; Q=Queens; S=Staten Island). Collectively, the letters and numbers make up the route (examples: M31, Bx9, M15). Signage at each bus stop indicates which buses stop there. Signage on the front of each bus indicates the route and destination of the bus. Bus maps for each borough can be found at the MTA website (<https://new.mta.info/maps/bus>).
- Express buses travel between Manhattan and the outer boroughs, usually to areas where the subway doesn't operate (such as eastern Queens, the eastern Bronx, southeast Brooklyn, and Staten Island). They cost \$6.75 but offer comfortable cloth seats and Wi-Fi, and are less crowded than the subway and local buses. Most express buses are identified by the borough they connect to Manhattan. Therefore, express buses to and from the Bronx would be labeled BxM (Bx for the Bronx, M for Manhattan; BxM11, BxM18), to and from Brooklyn BM (BM1, BM2), to and from Queens QM (QM1, QM2), and to and from Staten Island SIM (SIM1, SIM2). A few Brooklyn and Queens express buses are labeled with X (X27, X64).

Express buses have a slightly different appearance than normal buses, with only one entrance/exit in the front of the bus.

- The times posted on bus stops are often very unreliable, and may have nothing to do with the times the buses actually arrive. You can check the positions of the buses and their distance from a given stop online using MTA Bus Time (<http://bustime.mta.info/>). Each stop also has a QR code, with a link to that stop's entry.
- At night, there is a much longer wait time between buses. If you anticipate riding the bus at night, plan an alternate route, probably via subway or taxi.
- Bus fareboxes also accept coins. However, they will not accept pennies, half dollar (50-cent) coins, or bills. As a safety precaution, drivers do not handle money. Change is not given, so exact fares must be paid. If you pay with coins and require a free transfer, you will have to ask the driver for one after you have paid.
- Certain buses contain a small orange and purple card in the window that says "Limited." These limited buses do not make all local bus stops, stopping only at major cross streets. They are similar to express buses in some ways, but only cost the standard \$2.90 to ride. If a Limited bus skips your stop, you can wait for a local bus which will arrive soon. On some avenues served by multiple bus routes, some buses may operate Limited on the entire avenue or at least until they branch off. For example, with the M1, M2, M3, M4, and M5, the M2 and M5 provide limited-stop service on 5th Ave & Madison Ave during the day.
- **Select Bus Service (SBS)** (<http://web.mta.info/mta/planning/sbs/>) routes also make limited stops and cost the standard \$2.90 fare. These include the M14A, M14D, M15, M23, M34, M34A, M79, and M86 in Manhattan, the M60 in Manhattan and Queens, and several more routes in the outer boroughs. SBS routes can be identified by a special blue wrap around the lower half of the bus. *However, these buses operate on a very different payment system.* To board these SBS buses, *fares must be paid before boarding* using machines on the sidewalk at a special SBS bus stop, which is typically quite close to the local bus stop. Follow the instructions at the machine to pay. Once the fare has been paid, a receipt will be printed; *take it and keep it with you*. You may also use OMNY to pay SBS fares by entering the bus through any door and tapping the reader. Once the bus arrives, you can enter through any door, but if you paid with cash, remember to use the front door if you need to ask the driver for a transfer. Fare inspectors will occasionally check for your fare receipt as proof of payment; show it to them if they ask. If you don't have a valid receipt, you will be forced to pay a fine of up to \$100, so it is wise to always pay the fare. However, if you cannot buy the ticket successfully, such as due to a malfunctioning machine, note the machine number and report the problem to the bus driver near the front door at once. If the SBS skips your stop, wait at a local bus stop for a local bus.
- **Transfers** bus-to-bus, bus-to-subway, subway-to-bus transfers are automatic with OMNY payments within two hours of a tap (i.e., within two hours of entering the subway or boarding a bus).



Select bus service fares are paid before boarding at ticket machines at bus stops

By ferry

- The **Staten Island Ferry** (<https://www1.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/ferrybus/staten-island-ferry.shtml>), runs from Battery Park in southern Manhattan to Staten Island. The ferry carries passengers and bicycles only, runs every 15-20 minutes during rush hours and every 30 minutes at most other times, and is free (so don't be fooled by con artists trying to sell "advance tickets"). Not only does the ferry provide a means of transport, but it offers an amazing view of the Statue of Liberty and New York Harbor on its way. Even if you don't want to visit Staten Island, taking this trip is highly recommended. It is very popular with tourists. Ride on the starboard side of the ferry (right side facing the front) from Manhattan and the port side from Staten Island for the best views (to the west). If you want to take good photographs, try to get on the ferry as soon as the gates open and walk briskly to an open window (few windows are open to the air and will populate quickly). The Manhattan-to-Staten Island route passes slightly closer to the Statue of Liberty than the return route. For security reasons, all passengers must exit the ferry upon reaching the terminal.



Staten Island Ferry



New York City Ferry



- Passengers intending to make an immediate return trip must exit the ferry, walk through the terminal to the waiting area, then board the next departing ferry. While the Staten Island Ferry also used to carry vehicular traffic, it no longer has since the September 11, 2001 terrorist attacks for security reasons.
- **NYC Ferry** (<https://www.ferry.nyc/>) operates a network of ferries primarily along the East River connecting Manhattan with Queens, Brooklyn, The Bronx and Staten Island. There is also one route along the Hudson River connecting Midtown West with Staten Island. These ferries cost the same as a bus or subway at \$2.75 per ride (30 day passes are also available), with free transfers between ferries for 90 minutes. Tickets are available for purchase from vending machines or through the NYC Ferry app. There is an extra \$1 surcharge to bring a bike. Children under the height of 44 inches ride for free when accompanied by an adult.
 - **New York Waterway** (<https://www.nywaterway.com/>), operates ferries that connect the city with the New Jersey Hudson River Waterfront. One-way fares vary in price depending on the route. For example, the ferries from Hoboken, Lincoln Harbor and Port Imperial to Midtown cost \$9.00 each way, with an additional surcharge for carrying a bike. Reduced fares are offered for children and seniors.

By taxi

Taxis are widely available in New York, but due to surface traffic, it is often quicker to take the subway — or in Midtown Manhattan, to walk.

- **Yellow Cabs** cruise in most of Manhattan and are available at dispatcher lines at airports, but are harder to find in the other four boroughs. Real NYC taxis are yellow, have a metal seal on the hood ("medallion"), a light with a taxi number on the roof, a meter for billing, stickers on the windshield for various licenses, special taxi license plates, and a divider inside the car. The fares are \$2.50 plus a \$0.50 state tax to start, plus \$0.40 for each 1/5 mile traveled. There is a night surcharge from 8PM to 6AM of \$0.50 and a rush hour surcharge of \$1 M-F 4-8PM. In addition, as in the rest of the United States, tipping your taxi driver is expected in New York. For more information, see Tipping in the United States. Info on fares, flat fares, group rides and rules are online (http://www.nyc.gov/html/tlc/html/passenger/taxicab_rate.shtml). All yellow cabs accept Visa, MasterCard, and American Express for payment. In the unlikely event that the card reader is broken, the driver will let you know before you get into the taxi. To hail a taxi, stand visibly near the street (but away from moving traffic) with one arm raised over your head. The medallion numbers on the roof of the taxi will indicate the status of the taxi:

- If the medallion number is unlit, then the taxi is already occupied or otherwise unavailable.
- If the medallion number is lit, then the taxi is available for hire.

- **Borough Taxis** were introduced in 2013 to address the shortage of yellow cabs outside Manhattan. Unlike yellow cabs, they are light green and have no medallions on the hood. These cabs are barred from picking up passengers in Manhattan south of West 110th St or East 96th St and may not enter the airport dispatcher lines. They can, however, pick up passengers in northern Manhattan and the other boroughs, and can drop off passengers anywhere. Fares and rules are otherwise identical to yellow cabs.



A borough taxi, which can be identified by its light green color

- **Livery or Black Cars**, known as car services or livery cabs, may only be called by phone, and are flat rate rather than metered. In most areas, they are not allowed to cruise the street or airports for fares, although sometimes they will do so anyway. Ask for the fare while on the phone. Their license plates will say either "Livery" or "TLC" on the bottom.
- **Ride Hailing Smartphone App Services**, such as Uber, Lyft and Via are extremely popular. Many drivers of black livery cars also use them to secure passengers when their own dispatchers are idle, so it's often possible to get a car from them in under ten minutes even in outer neighborhoods. Beware that most such services use variable-rate (aka "surge") pricing, and even small local increases in demand such as a concert letting out can trigger a 1.5x to 3x fare increase: always provide a destination address when hailing a car via an app, and examine the estimated fare carefully! Using these apps requires a smartphone with a working data connection (potentially expensive if you are roaming on an international account), and a credit card which you have entered into the app: you cannot pay the fare in cash.

In some areas, livery cabs can be flagged on the street. Though this is not legal (the driver, not you, could get into trouble), it is useful in upper Manhattan and the outer boroughs and is accepted practice, though this has mostly been replaced by the Borough Taxis and ride hailing apps. The minimum fare in these cabs is about \$7, and it is advisable to negotiate the fare before you get inside (again, tipping your driver is expected). Since yellow cabs are hard to come by in the outer boroughs, these cars are particularly useful for getting to the airport (your hotel can arrange one, or look up car services in the Yellow Pages).

Taxi basics

- All licensed taxis (yellow for in Manhattan and Green for outside of Manhattan) and sedan limousines are authorized to take 3 passengers in the backseat and 1 in the front seat for a total of 4. However, some of the newer minivan and SUV yellow cabs can seat more passengers and may take more than four passengers (even though the licensed limit is posted in the cab). Larger than sedan limousines can be reserved, also useful for airport trips with lots of luggage, by calling any of the dozens of companies in the yellow pages.
- Licensed taxis apply surcharges (in addition to the metered fare) depending on the time of day. From 6AM–4PM, the surcharge is \$0.50; from 4–8PM, the surcharge is \$1.50; from 8PM–6AM the surcharge is \$1. For all cabs, you must pay tolls for bridges, tunnels and highways. Be careful of being overcharged by drivers for toll crossings—on some bridges and tunnels (like the Queens-Midtown Tunnel) rates are not posted in plain view. So, a crossing which actually cost the cab driver \$4 is easily passed onto the unsuspecting passenger as a \$5 charge. Outside the city, other than flat fare destinations (such as JFK Airport and Newark Airport), meter rates are doubled (when going to Westchester or Nassau County). Tipping your driver is expected. The customary amount is 15% of the total fare, or more if you need to transport luggage or are going to a remote area of the city (where the cab driver will have a difficult time getting a return passenger). If you chose to use the credit card machine that is found in most taxis (it doubles as a TV screen, the default tip will be 20% or 25% but you can adjust this if you resist feeling pressured and punch in the desired amount.
- Be wary of unlicensed cars (known derisively as "gypsy cabs") cruising for passengers, especially near the airports or in areas not well served by yellow cabs. While drivers may claim to offer you a cheaper rate than an actual taxi, your chances of actually getting this rate (not to mention getting to your destination safely and quickly) are slim. If you're willing to negotiate and know what you're doing, you might be okay, but you're better off asking an airport staffer for help finding a cab or cabstand. Major airports have taxi information cards for passengers. Always settle on a price before getting into the car.
- There are also van and shuttle services in different parts of the city. You will have to ask where it is going and how much it costs. Usually, you will see people lining up and a van will appear and they will board. There are services between Chinatown and Queens (you won't have to make any transfers if it goes where you need to go!), and also there are separate services in Brooklyn, and Queens. Many of these services are branded as "Dollar Vans" (actually costing \$2.00), and follow major bus routes along major avenues in these boroughs and will drop you off and pick up at any corner along the avenue. Some are legal while most aren't and usually compete with each other for customers and may cut some other van drivers off. This is an accepted practice in these boroughs and at times are faster than MTA buses. The illegal vans may not have insurance so you ride at your own risk. Most drivers of these vans have heavy West Indian accents. Some may seem sketchy but for the most part are people just trying to make a living. They usually are helpful with directions. It is rare that incidents occur with them.
- While there are pedicabs in New York, they are generally used more for entertainment than for transit and are priced accordingly. They are rare to nonexistent outside of midtown Manhattan. Fares are usually posted on the vehicle.
- One may have heard of the NYPD using undercover taxis in policing. Despite concerns, these undercover taxis *do not* engage in taxi business.

By car

“No one in New York drove; there was too much traffic.”

Philip J. Fry, *Futurama*

A word of advice about driving in New York City: **don't**. A car is inadvisable — street parking is practically nonexistent near crowded areas and tourist attractions, and garage parking rates range from very expensive to plain extortion. Traffic is almost always congested, parking rules are confusing, and many drivers are infamously aggressive. Public transportation options are many, and are quicker, cheaper and more pleasant. That's why many New Yorkers, particularly in Manhattan, don't own cars. If you think of staying in a suburb and commuting to the city by car, better to do as the locals do. Drive to one of the commuter rail stations (see above) or ferry docks. Parking fees at the station and fare combined are usually much cheaper than parking downtown. Many stations have secure parking areas; however, it's wise to investigate beforehand. Some suburban stations limit their parking to local residents, with enforcement by license plate camera and aggressive ticketing of unregistered vehicles. In Staten Island, parking near the ferry terminal and using the ferry will save you money and time.

If you do choose to drive, a smartphone with GPS support and a mapping application with turn-by-turn directions and live traffic conditions support (such as Google Maps, Apple Maps or Waze) is invaluable: New York's eternal cycle of road, bridge and tunnel maintenance, not to mention the daily changes created by accidents, festivals and police activity mean that a published paper map may be catastrophically inaccurate, even if it's been published comparatively recently. Many rental cars may not have a USB power port and even those that do will not provide a charge cable: bringing your own car power adaptor is a must if you're renting.

In Queens, numbers identify not only avenues and streets, but also roads, places, crescents, and lanes, all of which might be near each other. Read the entire street sign. Outer borough highways are confusing and often narrowed to one lane, the potholes could trap an elephant, the signs are sometimes misleading, exits which should appear do not, and signs directing a



The Brooklyn Bridge



Congestion pricing

As if you needed another reason to avoid driving into Manhattan, the MTA introduced a congestion pricing system in 2025, which charges motor vehicles for entering Manhattan below 60th Street via license plate scanners.

- Passenger vehicles are charged \$9 to enter the area between 9AM and 9PM (limited to once per day, so leaving and reentering the zone in the same day would not incur a second charge). Larger vehicles are charged up to \$21.60.
- Taxis are charged \$0.75 per trip into the zone. Other for-hire vehicles such as for Uber are charged \$1.50 per trip.
- Entering the zone after 9PM incurs a 75% discount.
- Entering the zone via tunnels which already charge tolls (Queens-Midtown, Brooklyn-Battery, Holland, Lincoln) also gives a reduction.
- The charge does not apply to vehicles that stay on the West Side Highway or FDR Drive and stay off the streets themselves.
- Vehicles without E-ZPass are given a 50% surcharge.

highway approach drag you through miles of colorful neighborhood (in the wrong direction) before finally letting you onto the highway with a stop sign and a hand's width of merge space.

Traffic in New York City roughly follows a hierarchy of precedence, which it is unwise to challenge. Fire engines, ambulances, and police cruisers are given priority, followed by other public service vehicles such as buses, road crews, and sanitation trucks. Beneath them are taxi cabs and delivery trucks. Below *those* are other cars. Driving a car with out-of-state license plates (save for perhaps Connecticut or New Jersey) will instantly mark you as an outsider, sometimes resulting in other drivers being more aggressive around you than they would with a local. Suffice it to say, driving in New York is not for the timid or emotionally fragile.

However, driving can be an exciting adventure, particularly on the parkways, with their numerous twists and turns. (Just watch out for other drivers, as noted above.) Also, since buses don't serve some of the parkways, driving or taking a taxi might be a workable option for those. Nonetheless, try to use bicycles or walk on the pedestrian trails near those parkways, where they exist; trails are less harrowing and you'd probably enjoy the scenery better.

Gas

Gas stations can be found along main streets in the outer boroughs, but are sparse in Manhattan where only a handful exist around the perimeter of the island and in neighborhoods north of Central Park. Avoid filling your gas tank on highways within city limits—these charge a lot more compared to neighborhood gas stations.

Parking

Parking in garages or outdoor lots is usually very expensive, costing as much as \$40 per day in Manhattan, although cheap or free lot parking is available at some times at certain locations. Street parking can be free or much cheaper than garage or lot parking, but can be extremely hard to come by. In Manhattan, self-park (or "park-and-lock") is extremely rare. The overwhelming majority of parking facilities in Manhattan have mandatory valet parking, so you must set aside a few dollars for tips, and anticipate the time it will take for a valet to retrieve your vehicle. Self-park garages in Manhattan near major tourist attractions include the Battery Parking Garage in Lower Manhattan, Manhattan Plaza Parking in Midtown Manhattan, and the public parking garage underneath the Metropolitan Museum of Art. As a general rule, hotels in New York do not supply garage parking. The few that do will charge you handsomely for the privilege. There are several websites and mobile apps that can help you find and book parking, including: ParkMe.com (<http://www.parkme.com/new-york-city-parking>), SpotHero (<http://spothero.com/>), ParkWhiz.com (<https://www.parkwhiz.com/p/new-york-parking/>), BestParking.com (<http://nyc.bestparking.com/>), Parkopedia.com (<http://en.parkopedia.com>), IconParking.com (<http://www.iconparking.com/>), and ParkFast.com (<http://www.parkfast.com/>).

In the case of parallel parking on the street, "bumping" cars in front of and behind of you to get into and out of a parking spot (known to some as "Braille Parking") is common. If you choose to park on the street, don't be surprised if you find a few new scratches and scrapes on your bumper.

Check all parking signs carefully. Parking meters demand constant feeding, and are hungry late into the night in some areas. In some parts of Midtown Manhattan, there are pay-and-display meters which are only in effect from 6PM to midnight on weekdays and all day on weekends. In

these areas, parking is prohibited during the workday, except for commercial trucks. It is a good idea to keep a roll of quarters in your car, as not all meters accept credit cards. Parking is permitted at broken or missing meters for the time posted on the signs. Parking is illegal at ALL bus stops and within 15 ft (4.6 m) of fire hydrants. Yellow lines on the curb have no legal meaning in NYC, so they cannot be relied upon to tell you if you are parked far enough from a hydrant. However, in most areas the seams in the sidewalk are roughly five feet apart, so leaving at least three "squares" of sidewalk between the hydrant and your bumper is a smart move. Many motorists simply pay garage fees to avoid the anxiety of finding a parking spot and the risks of expensive parking tickets.

New York has "alternate side of the street" parking rules (<http://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/motorist/alternate-side-parking.shtml>), which may require street parkers to move their cars at different times of the day (such as early morning, or overnight in a few business districts) so that street sweepers can clean the roads. Alternate side rules are suspended on many obscure holidays, while parking meters and other weekday restrictions are only suspended on a few major holidays (not even on all Federal holidays). The current state of parking enforcement can always be found on the "NYC 311" service: dial 311 on any phone, visit [their website \(https://www1.nyc.gov/311/\)](https://www1.nyc.gov/311/) or install the 311 application on your smartphone.

Trying to leave a car parked illegally for very long will often end with a \$150 fine, and a vehicle illegally parked in an overcrowded place is very likely to be towed away and face a \$300 fine. The New York Police Department operates [the tow pounds \(http://www.nyc.gov/html/nypd/html/towed_vehicles/towed_vehicles.shtml\)](http://www.nyc.gov/html/nypd/html/towed_vehicles/towed_vehicles.shtml).

Rentals

The major car rental agencies have offices at all three airports as well as throughout the city. Smaller agencies are also well represented. Be warned that car rentals in New York are generally more expensive than elsewhere in the United States, especially on weekends, when the locals rent cars to get out of the city. Rentals may require a deposit of up to \$500 if you do not have a credit card. New York state law caps rental car collision damage waiver at \$9 per day (\$15 per day for premium cars), which is quite a bit less than in most other states. At that price, it's not a bad idea to add it to your rental, even if you have another source of coverage. (For more on rental car insurance in New York, check out the New York Attorney General's page on the subject. <http://www.ag.ny.gov/consumer-frauds/car-rental-tip-sheet>) Unlike most other states in the U.S., New York state law requires rental companies to rent to anyone at least 18 years of age, but there are hefty fees for those under 25. Car-sharing services like Zipcar and Hertz 24/7 are very well represented.

Rules

- The speed limit throughout the city is 25 mph (as of 2026).
- Unlike other places in the United States, **right turns on red are illegal**, except where otherwise posted. While some entrances to New York City have signs alerting motorists that it is illegal to turn on red, other drivers from out of town may not know this rule.
- As in the rest of New York State, talking on a cell-phone (without a hands-free device) or texting while driving is illegal. Even if you do have a hands-free device, minimize your talking and prioritize driving.
- There are red light cameras at 100 intersections in New York City. A camera will take a picture if you run a red light and a fine disputable on the web will be issued in 30 days.

However, since the camera does not identify who is driving the vehicle, no points will be issued against your drivers' license.

- Some bus lanes have video cameras. A camera will take a video if you drive illegally in the bus lane other than to turn right and a fine disputable on the web will be issued in 30 days.
- If there is an emergency vehicle trying to get through with its siren blaring, pull over to the side and move forward as necessary. On many one-way streets (avenues in particular), the middle lane is designated as the "FIRE LANE" so that motorists can pull over to either side lane.
- Some avenues and many streets have only one-way traffic. Thankfully, one-way streets generally alternate direction, so if your destination is down a one-way street going in the wrong direction, go another block and double-back. A handy mnemonic is "Evens go East," meaning that, for the most part, streets (in Manhattan) with even numbers will head east, and vice-versa. The best gauge to determine a one way street's direction is to check the direction parked cars face.
- Be wary of your surroundings when you park your car. While NYC is a safe city for its size, it's not necessarily safe for your car as well. Make it as unworthy to steal as possible.

Tolls

When entering New York from New Jersey (<http://www.panynj.gov/bridges-tunnels/tolls.html>), as well as when driving across the Throgs Neck Bridge, Whitestone Bridge, Verazzano-Narrows Bridge, Triboro Bridge, Midtown Tunnel and Brooklyn-Battery Tunnel within New York City (<http://web.mta.info/bandt/traffic/btmain.html>), you will incur tolls of up to \$15, and associated traffic delays.

Traffic

Traveling at off-hours makes sense to avoid rush hour traffic, but highways and roads are still generally packed any time of day. The Cross Bronx Expressway, which is part of I-95 and leads to the George Washington Bridge, is almost always choked with traffic. The Long Island Expressway has heavy eastbound traffic between the morning and evening rushes. The Holland and Lincoln Tunnels are 10-minute waits on a good day. The Brooklyn-Queens Expressway (BQE) is notorious, and an accident on the Verazzano Bridge without shoulders can cause a backup all the way through the northern part of Staten Island into New Jersey. It is a good idea to check radio traffic reports, especially before crossing a bridge or tunnel. Three different stations have reports every 10 minutes around the clock: 880 AM (on the 8's), 1010 AM (on the 1's, also available on 92.3 FM), and 1130 AM (on the 5's).

Driving cross-town (east-west) in Manhattan during rush hours is especially troublesome because the traffic lights are optimized to move traffic along the north-south roads. Your best bet is to avoid driving in Midtown Manhattan (between the 30s and 50s) whenever possible. If you do drive in Midtown Manhattan crosstown on weekdays, consider using "Thru Streets"—these streets restrict turns onto major avenues at certain intersections and may reduce delays. They are indicated with purple and white signs at intersections.

Trucks

If you are traveling with a commercial vehicle (defined as any vehicle designed to transport property with two axles and six tires, or three or more axles) remember that commercial traffic is prohibited on many roadways throughout the city. Commercial traffic is permitted only on roadways designated as Through and Local Truck Routes. [Commercial traffic \(http://www.nyc.g](http://www.nyc.g)

[ov/html/dot/html/motorist/commvehicle.shtml](http://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/motorist/commvehicle.shtml)) is prohibited on all multiple-lane roadways designated as "parkways" (such as the Grand Central Parkway, Cross-Island Parkway, or Henry Hudson Parkway) with frequent low bridges. Unfortunately, the majority of fast-moving roadways are designated as parkways in New York City. Commercial traffic is also prohibited on the Franklin Delano Roosevelt (FDR) Drive in Manhattan. Before traveling anywhere in New York City with a commercial vehicle, refer to the New York City Truck Route Map (http://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/downloads/pdf/2011_truck_route_map.pdf).

Tunnels

There are several points of entry/exit into the city from the New Jersey side: the Lincoln Tunnel (midtown/41st Street), the Holland Tunnel (downtown/Canal Street), and the George Washington Bridge (way uptown/178th Street) — all are accessible from the New Jersey Turnpike (I-95). I-78 east will also feed directly into the Holland Tunnel (US-1/9 is also a popular route). I-80 east will terminate at an I-95 junction, the north route of which will lead directly to the George Washington Bridge. The bridge is also directly accessible from US-46 east. With all of these options, many commuters choose to listen to 24 hour traffic reports on AM stations 880 (every ten minutes on the 8s) and 1010 (every ten minutes on the 1s, also available on 92.3 FM) to find the least congested route at that time. Weekend traffic delays can easily exceed 60 minutes at some of the tunnels, so plan accordingly!

The Midtown Tunnel under the East River is convenient for Long Island travelers, as it becomes the Long Island Expressway. The Queensborough Bridge (aka The 59th Street Bridge) also crosses the East River into Queens, is toll-free, and lands near the mouth of the Midtown Tunnel but requires some automotive manipulation to get onto a highway. Other routes head north and east out of the Bronx, including Interstates 87 (north to Albany) and 95 (northeast to Boston) and the Henry Hudson Parkway, which is along the Hudson River.

By bicycle

Using a bicycle in New York City (<http://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/bicyclists/bicyclists.shtml>) is common among New Yorkers and tourists alike. Bike paths can be found in every borough of the city, in three forms: bike lanes (road lanes specifically for bicycles), shared lanes (lanes shared between cars and bicycles), and greenways (roads solely designated to bicycles and pedestrians). Greenways are highly recommended for those wishing to go on a recreational journey. The Manhattan Waterfront Greenway circles (almost) the whole of Manhattan, and protected bikeways exist on some major avenues. However, most destinations will require some street biking. A map of bike paths in New York City can be found [here](http://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/bicyclists/b) (<http://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/bicyclists/b>



Cyclotouring group stopping for a lecture in Central Park

ikemaps.shtml). Bike shops give out free maps provided by the City. They show bike routes and shops, and indicate the ones that offer rentals.

The city has a bike share program called **CitiBike** (<http://citibikenyc.com/>). The program has over 750 stations in Manhattan and parts of Brooklyn, Queens, and the Bronx. A map can be found [here](https://account.citibikenyc.com/map) (<https://account.citibikenyc.com/map>). To access a bike install the app. You can also visit one of the locations and pay for a pass. A single ride costs \$3.81 to unlock plus \$0.18 per minute. Return your bike to a station (remember to place it securely in a dock—you will be further fined if the light on the dock does not turn green). CitiBike is good for short trips to a known destination and **not** recommended for using a bike for a prolonged period of time.

Cycling in Manhattan can often be quicker than taking the subway or a taxi, but it isn't for the fainthearted. The borough's tumultuous traffic makes biking difficult. Aggressive cab drivers, jaywalking pedestrians, potholes and debris on the roads create a cycling experience that might just as well have been taken from Dante's *Inferno*. If you do venture into the concrete jungle on a bike, make sure you wear a helmet and have sufficient experience in urban cycling.

Cycling in Brooklyn and The Bronx can be more rewarding, or not, depending on the neighborhood. There are few bike paths in Queens; however, the roads are bike-friendly for the most part.

Cycling is *not* recommended in Staten Island. Access is difficult, with the main way to get in being the Staten Island Ferry. There are only a handful of bike paths on the entire island, mostly on the south shore. This is unfortunate, as Staten Island has beautiful displays of nature in some of its parks, most of which are accessible only on foot or by bicycle. If you are looking for scenery, by all means, take your bike with you on the ferry, but do not rely on it for transportation on the street.

On foot

For shorter distances, there is no better way of getting around New York than hitting the sidewalk. If you use the subway or buses, you will almost certainly need to walk to and from stations or stops. In all areas of New York a traveler is likely to visit, all streets have wide, smoothly-paved sidewalks. For long distances, walking is also fine and a great way to see the city.

Wear shoes that protect your feet and you don't mind getting a bit dirty, such as sneakers or platform wedges. The sidewalks can be filthy, especially on trash day. Women all over the city routinely pack high heels, strappy sandals, or flip flops in a bag and put them on only after arriving at their destinations.

See

Like most of the great world cities, New York has an abundance of great attractions—so many, that it would be impossible to list them all here. What follows is but a sampling of the most high-profile attractions in New York City; more detailed info can be found in the district pages.

A general word of advice on sightseeing in New York: Tourists often spend their entire vacation in New York standing in line (or as New Yorkers say, "on line"). This is often unnecessary; there are usually alternatives. For example, one can choose to avoid the Empire State Building during

the day (it is open, and much quieter, late, until 2AM), skip the Statue of Liberty in favor of the Staten Island Ferry, and stay away from the Guggenheim on Monday (it is one of the only museums open that day). Also, there is no reason to stand in line for a Broadway show if you already have a ticket with an assigned seat. If you prefer, get a drink nearby and come back closer to curtain time, when you can walk right in. The lines for bus tours can be absurd because tourists all seem to have exactly the same itinerary, which is get on a bus in the morning in Times Square, get off for the Statue of Liberty, and finish on the East Side in the afternoon. Why not go downtown in the morning, and save Midtown for the afternoon? You will thank yourself for avoiding the crowds. Also, understand that buses are the slowest way to go crosstown in Midtown Manhattan during peak hours, and taxis are not much better. You are often better off on foot. Additionally, New York rush hour (especially in Manhattan) puts much of the city in gridlock: all subway lines and roads will be much busier from 4:30PM to 6:30PM.

Passes

A number of multi-attraction schemes give reduced prices and line-skipping privileges.

- **GoCity Pass (<https://gocity.com/new-york/en-us>)**. 2 passes are available from GoCity. The *Explorer* pass lets you can visit a set number of attractions, while the *All-Inclusive* pass which allows unlimited attractions for a set number of days. The Explorer pass cardholders have 30 days to use the card after visiting the first attraction; the All-Inclusive cardholders have the time-limit activate on the day of first use. Both passes allow holders to either print a paper-pass to scan, or to use an Android/iOS compatible phone app. Attractions include Top of the Rock Observation, Rockefeller Center Tour, Statue of Liberty and Ellis Island, Museum of Modern Art, NBC Studio Tour, movie tours, and cruises. Also included with the card are shopping, dining, and additional attraction discounts. The biggest attraction not included is the Metropolitan Museum of Art. Their newsletter may offer significant sales. (updated Sep 2022 |)
- **New York Pass (<http://www.newyorkpass.com/>)**. Also from GoCity. Grants access to over 50 top attractions with line skipping privileges. Passes are available for 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, or 10 days. You must obtain a ticket in each attraction. You can visit as many attractions as you want in the time period. Also includes a 140-page guide book, but is much better to organize your visits in advance on the internet. Prices are given as adult price/child (ages 4-12) price. 1 day: \$134/\$99; 2 day: \$199/\$159; 3 day: \$274/\$199; 4 day: \$299/\$224; 5 day: \$339/\$244; 7 day: \$379/\$259; 10 day: \$469/\$299. (updated Jul 2019 |)
- **New York CityPASS (<http://www.citypass.com/new-york>)**. Grants admission to 6 New York attractions within 9 days of first use for a much reduced rate. The attractions are the Empire State Building, the Metropolitan Museum of Art & same-day admission to The Cloisters, the American Museum of Natural History, Top of the Rock or the Guggenheim Museum, Statue of Liberty & Ellis Island Ferry or Circle Line Sightseeing Cruises, and the 9/11 Memorial & Museum or the Intrepid Sea, Air & Space Museum. \$132 adult, \$108 child ages 6–17. (updated Jul 2019 |)

See also the district pages for detailed information about attractions. Detail is gradually being moved from this page to the district pages.

Landmarks

Naturally, Manhattan possesses the lion's share of the landmarks that have saturated American popular culture. Starting in the Financial District, perhaps the most famous of these landmarks is easy to spot - the **Statue of Liberty (<http://www.nps.gov/stli/>)**, a symbol of the nation standing atop a small island in the harbor, and perhaps also the most difficult attraction to access in terms of crowds and the long lines to see it. Visitors may climb all the way up to the

crown inside the statue, but tickets are limited and should be reserved months in advance. Nearby **Ellis Island** preserves the site where millions of immigrants completed their journey to America. Within the Financial District itself, **Wall Street** acts as the heart of big business being the home of the **New York Stock Exchange**, although the narrow street also holds some historical attractions, namely **Federal Hall**, where George Washington was inaugurated as the first president of the United States. Furthermore, there is a large statue of a bull that tourists often take pictures with. Nearby, the National September 11 Memorial at the **World Trade Center Site** commemorates the victims of that fateful day, and its replacement, officially **One World Trade Center** but colloquially known as the **Freedom Tower**, is the tallest building in the country at 1,776 feet (representing the year which the United States of America was founded). Connecting the Financial District to Downtown Brooklyn, the **Brooklyn Bridge** offers fantastic views of the Manhattan and Brooklyn skylines.



Statue of Liberty



Moving north to Midtown, Manhattan's other major business district, you'll find some of New York's most famous landmarks. **Macy's Herald Square** is the flagship store of the nationwide chain, and perhaps the most famous department store in the country. The **Empire State Building** looms over Midtown, with the nearby **Chrysler Building** also dominating the landscape. Nearby is the headquarters of **United Nations** overlooking the East River and **Grand Central Terminal**, one of the busiest train stations in the world. Also nearby is the main branch of the **New York Public Library**, a beautiful building famous for its magnificent reading rooms and the lion statues outside the front door; and **Rockefeller Plaza**, home to NBC Studios, Radio City Music Hall, and (during the winter) the famous Christmas Tree and Skating Rink.

Still in the Midtown area but just to the west, in the Theater District, is the tourist center of New York: **Times Square**, filled with bright, flashing video screens and LED signs running 24 hours a day. Just to the north is **Central Park**, with its lawns, trees and lakes popular for recreation and concerts.

Out in Queens you can find the **Unisphere** in Flushing Meadows–Corona Park, that was built as the centrepiece of the 1964 World's Fair.

Museums and galleries

New York has some of the finest museums in the world, many of which are priced accordingly. In addition to the major museums, hundreds of small galleries are spread throughout the city, notably in neighborhoods like Chelsea and Williamsburg. Many galleries and museums in New York close on Mondays, so be sure to check hours before visiting. The following is just a list of highlights; see district pages for more listings.

Arts and culture

New York City is home to some of the finest art museums in the world, and in Manhattan, you'll find the grandest of them all. The **Metropolitan Museum of Art** in Central Park has vast holdings that represent a series of collections, each of which ranks in its category among the finest in the world. Within this single building you'll find perhaps the world's finest collection of American artwork, period rooms, thousands of European paintings including Rembrandts and Vermeers, the greatest collection of Egyptian art outside Cairo, one of the world's finest Islamic art collections, Asian art, European sculpture, medieval and Renaissance art, and antiquities from around the ancient world. Its collection is so vast that it would be impossible to see everything in a week. As if all that wasn't enough, the Met also operates **The Cloisters** in Fort Tryon Park in Upper Manhattan, which houses a collection of medieval art and incorporates elements from five medieval French cloisters and other monastic sites in southern France in its renowned gardens.

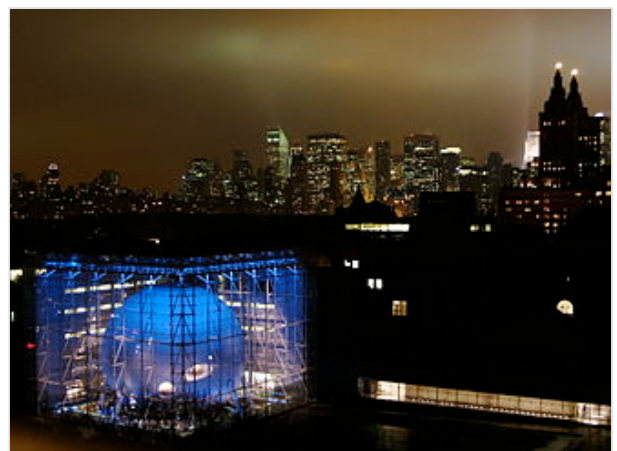
Near the Metropolitan, in the Upper East Side, is the **Guggenheim Museum**. Although more famed for its architecture than the collection it hosts, the spiraling galleries are ideal for exhibiting art works. The nearby **Frick Collection** houses a smaller though well-regarded collection of paintings by the old masters. In Midtown, the **Museum of Modern Art (MoMA)** holds the most comprehensive collection of modern art in the world, and is so large as to require multiple visits to see all of the works on display, which include Van Gogh's *Starry Night* and Picasso's *Les Femmes d'Alger*, as well as an extensive industrial design collection. Midtown is also home to the **Paley Center for Media**, a museum dedicated to television and radio, including a massive database of old shows. The **Whitney Museum of American Art**, with a collection of contemporary American art, can be found in the Meatpacking District.

In Brooklyn's Prospect Park, the **Brooklyn Museum of Art** is the city's second largest art museum with excellent collections of Egyptian art, Assyrian reliefs, 19th-century American art, and art from Africa and Oceania, among other things. Long Island City in Queens is home to a number of art museums, including the **PS1 Contemporary Art Center**, an affiliate of the Museum of Modern Art, and the **Museum of the Moving Image**, which showcases movies and the visual arts.

Science and technology

In New York City, no museum holds a sway over children like the **American Museum of Natural History** in Manhattan's Upper West Side. Containing the Hayden Planetarium, incredible astronomy exhibits, animal dioramas, many rare and beautiful gems and mineral specimens, anthropology halls, and one of the largest collections of dinosaur skeletons in the world, this place offers plenty of stunning sights.

Near Times Square in the Theater District, the **Intrepid Sea, Air & Space Museum** takes up a pier on the Hudson River, with the aircraft



The night is illuminated by the Rose Center for Earth and Space, home of the astronomy wing at the American Museum of Natural History.

carrier *Intrepid* docked here and holding some incredible air and space craft, including a former British Airways Concorde.

Over in the Flushing district of Queens, on the grounds of the former World's Fair, is the **New York Hall of Science**, which incorporates the Great Hall of the fair and now full of hands-on exhibits for kids to enjoy.

Another standout museum is the **New York Transit Museum** in an abandoned subway station in Downtown Brooklyn. The old subway cars are a real treat and the museum is *a must* if you're in New York with kids (and well-worth it even if you're not).

Until the mid-20th century, New York was a predominantly industrial city. While most factories have been torn down, some neighborhoods, such as SoHo and the Meatpacking District, remain as a heritage of manufacturing. See the American Industry Tour.

Neighborhoods

Like all great cities, New York is made up of distinct neighborhoods, each of which has its own flavor. Many of the neighborhoods are popular with visitors, and all are best experienced on foot. See individual borough pages (Manhattan, Brooklyn, Queens, Bronx, and Staten Island) for a comprehensive listing of neighborhoods.

Parks

Though the image many people have of New York is endless skyscrapers and packed sidewalks, the city also boasts numerous lovely parks, ranging from small squares to the 850-acre **Central Park**. There are worthwhile parks in every borough, more than enough to keep any visitor busy. These include **Fort Tryon Park** in Upper Manhattan, which boasts grand views of the New Jersey Palisades, the grand **Pelham Bay Park** in The Bronx, the popular **Prospect Park** in Brooklyn, the famous **Flushing Meadows Park** in Corona, Queens, site of the U.S. Open Tennis Tournament, and the wondrous **Greenbelt** in Staten Island, a collection of beautiful parks and protected forests unlike any other park in the city. New York City is also home to portions of the **Gateway National Recreation Area**. Almost any park is a great spot to rest, read, or just relax and watch the people streaming past. To find out more about New York City parks, go to the New York City Department of Parks & Recreation website (<http://www.nycgovparks.org/>) and the guide pages for each borough. Except for special events, all NYC parks are closed 1AM–6AM. The exception to this rule is parks affiliated with schools, which are closed for the entire time the sun is down.

Entertainment

Theater and performing arts

New York boasts an enormous number and variety of theatrical performances. Most of these are concentrated in Manhattan, particularly the Theater District around Times Square, where you'll find the major musicals and big-name dramatic works of Broadway. These are the most popular with visitors, with tickets for some shows running to \$130 a seat, though discounters make cheaper seats available. And if you're in town in early June (and willing to spend a lot of money), it's possible to purchase tickets to the Tony Awards, Broadway's biggest award ceremony and the culmination of the theatrical season in the city. However, you can also find "Off-Broadway" shows (and even the dirt cheap and very small "Off-Off-Broadway" shows) throughout Manhattan that play to smaller audiences and are far less expensive. Playbill.com (<http://www.playbill.com>) is a good resource for current and upcoming Broadway and Off-Broadway info and listings. See the Manhattan page for more detailed info on theater offerings.

Some of New York's (and the world's) most high profile music and dance halls include the **Brooklyn Academy of Music** in Downtown Brooklyn, **Carnegie Hall** — the premier venue for classical music in the United States — in Manhattan's Theater District, **Radio City Music Hall** — home of the Rockettes — in Midtown, and **Lincoln Center** in the Upper West Side, home to the prestigious Chamber Music Society, the Metropolitan Opera ("the Met"), the New York City Ballet, and the New York Philharmonic. There are also numerous small companies putting on more idiosyncratic shows every night of the week.

Film and television

New York is one of the world's greatest film cities, home to a huge number of theaters playing independent and repertory programs. Many major US studio releases open earlier in New York than elsewhere (especially in the autumn) and can be found at the major cineplexes (AMC, United Artists, etc.) around the city. As with everything else in New York, movies are quite popular, and even relatively obscure films at unappealing times of the day can still be sold out. It's best to get tickets in advance whenever possible. As many films premiere in New York, you can often catch a moderated discussion with the director or cast after the show. Sometimes even repertory films will have post-screening discussions or parties. Check listings for details.

In addition to the many commercial multiplexes throughout the city, some of the more intriguing New York film options include the several theaters in Greenwich Village and the East Village which play independent and foreign releases, many of which are screened only in New York. The **Film Society at Lincoln Center** in the Upper West Side puts on a terrific repertory program and shows a wide variety of experimental and foreign films, and also hosts the prestigious New York Film Festival in October. Another major film festival is the **Tribeca Film Festival**, held each May and a prominent event in New York's film calendar. The **Museum of the Moving Image** in Long Island City in Queens puts on a terrific screening program, with films showing

continuously throughout the day, while **MoMa** in Midtown Manhattan puts on a terrific repertory program (and compared to other New York movie theaters, tickets to films at MoMA are a steal).

Virtually every major national television network has studios in Manhattan, particularly the Midtown area, and many well-known programs are open to viewers. **Rockefeller Center** is home to NBC Studios and its flagship shows, including *Saturday Night Live* and *Today*, and is open for tours. **Lincoln Square** boasts programming produced for ABC, such as *The View* and *Who Wants to Be a Millionaire*, at the network's West 66th Street facility. More examples of popular programs you can see in person can be found on the Manhattan page.

Parades

New York City hosts many parades, street festivals and outdoor pageants. The following are the most famous:

- **New York's Village Halloween Parade.** Each Halloween (October 31) at 7PM. This parade and street pageant attracts 2 million spectators and 50,000 costumed participants along Sixth Avenue between Spring Street and 21st Street. Anyone in a costume is welcome to march; those wishing to should show up between 6PM-9PM at Spring Street and 6th Avenue.
- **Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade.** The morning of each Thanksgiving on Central Park West, this parade attracts many spectators and is broadcast on nationwide television.
- **St. Patrick's Day Parade.** The largest St. Paddy's parade in the world! Route is up 5th Ave from 44th Street to 86th Street and lasts from 11AM to about 2:30. Celebrations in pubs citywide happen the rest of the day and night until the green beer runs out.
- **Labor Day (aka West Indian Day Parade or New York Caribbean Carnival).**

The Labor Day Carnival, or West Indian Carnival, is an annual celebration held in Crown Heights, Brooklyn. Its main event is the West Indian-American Day Parade, which attracts between one and three million spectators, who watch the parade on its route along Eastern Parkway.

Sports

A number of professional and collegiate teams play in the New York metropolitan area.

- The **New York Yankees** play Major League Baseball at **Yankee Stadium** in the Bronx (East 161st Street and River Avenue. Subway: 4, B, D to 161st Street-Yankee Stadium). One of the most storied and lucrative sports franchises in the world, the Yankees have won 27 World Series championships in all, and have had many of the greatest players in baseball history play for the team including Babe Ruth, Lou Gehrig, Joe DiMaggio, Yogi Berra, Mickey Mantle, Derek Jeter and Mariano Rivera. The original Yankee Stadium (known as "The House That Ruth Built" in reference to baseball legend Babe Ruth), was replaced by the current, more modern incarnation of the ballpark in 2009. The former site of the stadium before its relocation across the road is now a park.



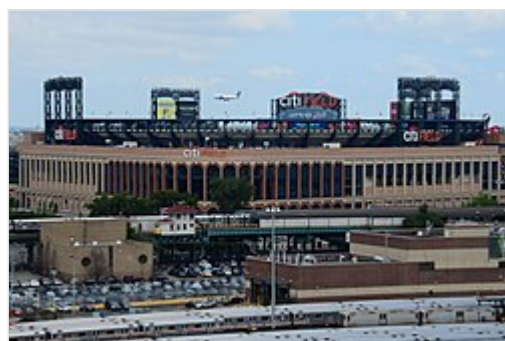
West Indian Day Parade-goers in front of the Brooklyn Museum on Eastern Parkway



- **Citi Field** in Flushing Meadows (126th Street and Roosevelt Avenue. Subway: 7 to Mets-Willets Point) is home to the **New York Mets**, who play in the National League of Major League Baseball unlike the Yankees (who play in the American League). The history of the National League in New York dates back to the 1800s with two teams: the New York Giants (not to be confused with the NFL's New York Giants), and Brooklyn Dodgers. When both of these teams moved to California in 1958, New York was left without the National League until 1962, when the Mets were born. The Mets have won two World Series titles since their inception. Notably, Citi Field is known for the Home Run Apple that rises when the Mets score a home run. This feature dates back to 1980, when the apple was first installed at Citi Field's predecessor venue, Shea Stadium. Citi Field first opened in 2009, around the same time as the new Yankee Stadium's first game.
- In addition to its many concerts and the annual Westminster Dog Show, **Madison Square Garden** hosts the **New York Knicks** of the NBA and **New York Rangers** of the NHL, plus annual postseason college basketball for the Big East Conference. It had been home to the New York Liberty of the WNBA through the 2017 season, but that team now shares Barclays Center with the Brooklyn Nets. (Pennsylvania Plaza. Subway: 1, 2, 3, A, C, E to 34th Street-Penn Station). Madison Square Garden advertises itself as "The World's Most Famous Arena", and it's easy to see why.
- Long based in New Jersey, the **Brooklyn Nets** basketball team moved to **Barclays Center** in Brooklyn (Vanderbilt Yards. Subway: 2, 3, 4, 5, B, D, N, Q, R to Atlantic Avenue-Barclays Center) when that arena opened in 2012. The aforementioned **New York Liberty**, now owned by the Nets' owner, moved to Barclays Center in 2021 (delayed from 2020 by COVID-19).
- Other NHL teams are the **New York Islanders** and **New Jersey Devils**. The Islanders now play at **UBS Arena** in Elmont, just outside Queens and a little less than 20 miles east of Midtown (LIRR: Elmont), which opened in November 2021. Notably, the arena is next to the Belmont Park horse racing track. The Devils skate at the **Prudential Center** in Newark, New Jersey, 12 miles west of midtown.
- Two National Football League teams play at **MetLife Stadium** in East Rutherford, New Jersey, 10 miles northwest of midtown Manhattan. The **New York Giants** in the National Football Conference have won four Super Bowls, while the **New York Jets** of the American Football Conference have won one.
- **Brooklyn Cyclones** (<http://www.brooklyncyclones.com/>). Play Minor League Baseball (South Atlantic League- North Division) at **Maimonides Park** (Subway: D, F, Fd, N, Q at Coney Island–Stilwell Avenue). They are an owned and operated High-A affiliate of the Mets, one of the surviving Short Season A teams that moved to full-season play in 2021.
- The **Staten Island FerryHawks** of the MLB Partner Atlantic League took over for the former Staten Island Yankees in 2022, playing at SIUH Community Park, located a short walk from the Staten Island Ferry terminal.



Yankee Stadium, an architectural replica of the "House that Ruth Built"



Citi Field, known for its fan atmosphere and concessions



Madison Square Garden, the self-proclaimed "World's Most Famous Arena"

- The Knicks and Nets both field teams in the NBA G League, the official minor league of the NBA, with both playing in the suburbs. The **Westchester Knicks** play at the **Westchester County Center** in White Plains, while the **Long Island Nets** play at the **Nassau Coliseum**, the former home of the Islanders in Uniondale (a bit more than 25 miles east of Midtown).
- There are four top-level soccer franchises, two men's and two women's, in the Tri-State area. The **New York Red Bulls** (Major League Soccer) play home matches at **Sports Illustrated Stadium** (recently renamed from Red Bull Arena) in Harrison, New Jersey, 11 miles from midtown Manhattan. **New York City FC** (partially owned by the Yankees) became the Tri-State's second MLS team in 2015; they are playing in Yankee Stadium until they can build a new stadium of their own. **Gotham FC**, a member of the National Women's Soccer League, has shared SI Stadium with the Red Bulls since 2020. The women's team of **Brooklyn FC** plays at Maimonides Park in the USL Super League, which began play in 2024 as the country's second top-level women's league.
- The **New York Sirens** play in the Professional Women's Hockey League, sharing Prudential Center with the New Jersey Devils.
- NCAA Division I athletic programs around New York City include the following:
 - **St. John's Red Storm** (St. John's University) in Jamaica, Queens. Higher-profile men's basketball games are often played at the Garden, while other basketball games are played at **Carnesecca Arena** (named after long-time coach Lou Carnesecca) on campus.
 - **Seton Hall Pirates** (Seton Hall University) in South Orange, New Jersey (20 miles west of midtown). Men's basketball games are played at the Prudential Center.
 - **Rutgers Scarlet Knights** (the main campus of Rutgers University) in New Brunswick and Piscataway, New Jersey, with most of the athletic facilities in the latter (40 miles southwest of midtown). Basketball games are played at **Jersey Mike's Arena** (commonly known as the RAC, for Rutgers Athletic Center), while football games are played at **SHI Stadium**.
 - **Army Black Knights** (United States Military Academy) in West Point, New York (50 miles north of midtown). Basketball games are played at **Christl Arena**, while football games are played at **Michie Stadium**.
 - **Columbia Lions** (Columbia University) in Morningside Heights, Manhattan. Basketball games are played at the **Levien Gymnasium**, while football games are played at **Lawrence A. Wien Stadium**.
 - **Fordham Rams** (Fordham University) in Fordham, Bronx. Basketball games are played at the **Rose Hill Gymnasium**, while football games are played at **Jack Coffey Field**.
 - **Manhattan Jaspers** (Manhattan College) in Riverdale, Bronx. Basketball games are played at the **Draddy Gymnasium**.
 - **LIU Sharks** (Long Island University), with some sports (most notably basketball) in Downtown Brooklyn and others (most notably football) in the Nassau County community of Brookville (25 miles east of midtown). The Sharks started play in the 2019–20 school year following the university's decision to merge the sports teams of its two main campuses. Higher profile basketball games are played at Barclays Center, while other basketball games are played at the **Steinberg Wellness Center**. Football games are played at **Bethpage Federal Credit Union Stadium**.
 - **Wagner Seahawks** (Wagner College) in Grymes Hill, Staten Island. Basketball games are played at the **Spiro Sports Center**, while football games are played at **Hameline Field**.
 - **Iona Gaels** (Iona University) in New Rochelle, New York (20 miles northeast of midtown). Basketball games are played at the **Hynes Athletic Center**.
 - **NJIT Highlanders** (New Jersey Institute of Technology) in Newark, New Jersey (9 miles west of midtown). A few men's basketball games are played at the Prudential Center, while the rest are played at the **Wellness and Events Center**.

- **Saint Peter's Peacocks** (Saint Peter's University) in Jersey City, New Jersey (9 miles southwest of midtown). Basketball games are played in **Run Baby Run Arena**, located within the **Yanitelli Center** (which includes facilities for several other indoor sports).
- **Stony Brook Seawolves** (Stony Brook University) in Stony Brook in Suffolk County (55 miles east of midtown). Basketball games are played at the **Island Federal Credit Union Arena**, while football games are played at **Kenneth P. LaValle Stadium**.
- The **USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center** in Flushing Meadows (Corona Park. Subway: 7 to Mets-Willets Point) is the site of the **US Open tennis tournament**, held yearly in late August and early September. This event is one of the most prestigious tournaments in tennis. The tennis center is located just south of Citi Field.
- Part of American horse racing's Triple Crown, the **Belmont Stakes** are run in June at **Belmont Park** (LIRR: Belmont Park when track is open, Elmont year-round) in nearby Elmont, 20 miles east of midtown Manhattan and also next to UBS Arena. (The exact timing is five weeks after the Kentucky Derby, a race that is always held on the first Saturday of May.) However, due to a complete reconstruction of the grandstands, the Belmont Stakes moved upstate to Saratoga Race Course in Saratoga Springs for 2024 and 2025.

Learn

New York City has a number of learning opportunities.

Columbia University (<http://www.columbia.edu>), a member of the Ivy League, is, without a doubt, the most prestigious university in the city. It is adjacent to and affiliated with **Barnard College** (<https://barnard.edu/>), a top women's school. **New York University** (<http://www.nyu.edu/>) (NYU) is also highly selective. Another notable university is **Rockefeller University** (<http://www.rockefeller.edu/>), a graduate-only school at which several significant biomedical discoveries were made. And the city also has its very own system of public colleges, **City University of New York**, with every borough represented among its numerous branches.



Columbia University



Buy

It is not a lie: New York City is one of the world's most expensive cities. One survey revealed that the city is the most expensive city in the world for expatriate workers. That being said, there are ways to limit the damage; food is available from many halal food trucks for \$7-10, which will get you rice with meat, vegetables and a soft drink, and you can still find inexpensive pizza slices at many of the hole-in-the-wall pizzerias throughout the city. Supermarkets and convenience stores generally also sell basic items at reasonable prices (by Western standards). New York's public bathroom infrastructure is lacking, so buying an item at a facility with a bathroom is generally advisable if you are far from your accommodation.

New York is the fashion capital of the United States, and is a major shopping destination for people around the world. The city boasts an unmatched range of department stores, boutiques, and specialty shops. Some neighborhoods boast more shopping options than most other American cities and have become famous as consumer destinations. Anything you could possibly

want to buy can be found in New York, including clothing, cameras, computers and accessories, music, musical instruments, electronic equipment, art supplies, sporting goods, and all kinds of foodstuffs and kitchen appliances. See the **borough pages** and **district sub-pages** for listings of some of the more important stores and major business districts, of which there are several. New York state has a sales tax exemption on all clothing items that cost less than \$100.

The popular place to begin is Manhattan, most notably Fifth Avenue in Midtown Manhattan, where the iconic flagship stores of many major department stores such as Saks Fifth Avenue (<http://www.saksfifthavenue.com>) and Bergdorf Goodman (<http://www.bergdorfgoodman.com/>) are located. Other notable department stores in Manhattan include the world-famous Macy's (<http://1.macys.com/new-york-ny>) at Herald Square, Bloomingdale's (<https://www.bloomingdales.com/>) on 59th Street between 3rd and Lexington Avenues, and Nordstrom (<https://www.nordstrom.com/>) on Broadway at 57th Street. Of course, for dirt-cheap knockoffs, the various Chinatowns in Manhattan, Queens and Brooklyn respectively are the place to go.

New York City is not known for budget shopping, but during major sales, such as the Black Friday sale after Thanksgiving, prices of some out-of-season items have been known to be slashed by as much as 50%, meaning that it is possible to find good deals for genuine luxury brand-name items if you are there at the right time. Savvy New Yorkers shop after Christmas and especially after New Year's.

Airports

Most shops in New York-area airports are chain outlets, the same as can be found in most large airports in the world, so it's pretty difficult to feel the spirit of the fashion capital if you only have 2 hours waiting for a connecting flight. At JFK, JetBlue Airways' new Terminal 5 is populated with modern, cutting-edge restaurants and shops, but terminals 4 and 8 are also relatively good places for retail and duty-free shopping.

Convenience stores, pharmacies, and supermarkets

Basic food, drinks, snacks, medicine, and toiletries can be found at decent prices at the ubiquitous **Duane Reade** (<http://www.duanereade.com/>) (owned by Walgreens), **CVS**, and **Rite Aid** stores. For a more authentically New York experience, stop by one of the thousands of bodegas/delis/groceries. Although some of these stores have a somewhat ramshackle appearance, they are reliable though often not the cheapest places to purchase groceries, water, flowers, coffee, and cooked food, typically 24/7.

There are several local and regional chains of supermarkets represented all over the city, including **Associated**, **C-Town**, **D'Agostino's**, **Foodtown**, **Gristedes** and **Key Food**, and **Fairway** and **West Side Market** have a few locations. There are also chains such as **Hong Kong Supermarket** and **H-Mart**, which cater primarily to Chinese and Korean customers, respectively. National chains selling food include **Trader Joe's**, **Whole Foods Market**, **Costco** (membership required; mostly in bulk) and **Target**.

Outlets

New York City has a number of retail outlet locations, offering substantial discounts and the opportunity to purchase ends-of-line and factory seconds.

Street vendors

In New York City it is common for street vendors to set up tables on the sidewalk, close to the curb, and sell items. They are required to obtain a permit to perform this activity, but it is legal. Purchasing from these vendors is generally legitimate, although buying brand name goods from them (particularly expensive clothing and movies) is generally ill-advised unless you want cheap imitation products. It is considered safe to buy less expensive goods from these vendors, but most will not accept payment by credit card, so you will have to bring cash. Be particularly wary of any street vendor that does not sell from a table (especially vendors who approach you with their merchandise in a briefcase), as these goods are almost certainly cheap imitation products.

Anyone can freely create, display, and sell art, including paintings, prints, photographs, sculptures, DVDs, and CDs, based on freedom of speech rights. Thousands of artists earn their livings on New York's streets and parks. Common places to find street artists selling their work are SoHo, the Financial District and near the Metropolitan Museum of Art.

Eat

New York has, as you might expect of the Big Apple, all the eating options covered and you can find almost every type of food available and every cuisine of the world represented. There are literally tens of thousands of restaurants, ranging from dingy cheap pizza-by-the-slice joints to \$500-a-plate *prix fixe* sushi. Thousands of delis, bodegas, and grocery stores dot every corner of the city and do it yourself meals are easy and cheap to find. Street food comes in various tastes, ranging from the ubiquitous New York hot dog vendors to the many Middle Eastern carts at street corners in Midtown. Fast food is as plentiful and as diverse as you can imagine. Fruit stalls appear at many intersections from spring to fall with ready-to-eat strawberries, bananas, apples, etc. available at very low cost. Vegetarian and vegan options abound throughout the city.

Don't leave without trying

New York pizza

A peculiarly New York thing, a true New York pizza is a plain cheese pizza with a very thin crust (sometimes chewy, sometimes crisp), and an artery-hardening sheen of grease on top. From just about any pizzeria, you can get a whole pie with a variety of toppings available, or a "dollar slice" if you just want a piece of plain cheese pizza. The "dollar slice" cost \$1 at the start of the 21st century, but prices have risen, and it may cost anywhere between \$1.50 and \$4 before sales tax, depending on the place and any toppings you want. Just fold in half lengthwise, grab a lot of napkins, and eat – the quintessential meal on the go in New York. Dollar-slice places can



A slice of the real deal



be found all over the city, and include the many different variations of "Ray's Pizza", all of which claim to be the original thing. However, perhaps the most respected of the corner joints is the wildly popular **Joe's** in Greenwich Village.

But while pizza in New York is generally considered a fast food, the most respected pizzerias in the city are those that act like sit-down restaurants, and some of them serve whole pies only, no slices. Except for DiFara's, all the following pizzerias use a classic New York style of coal-fired, rather than gas-fired ovens, which allows them to bake their pizza for a very short time at very high temperatures, producing a unique style of crispy, slightly charred crust that makes their output quite different from the average corner slice shop. Every New Yorker has their own personal favorite, but several routinely make it to the top of the list. **Lombardi's** in Little Italy is regarded as the oldest pizzeria in town and continues to draw in big crowds of tourists, but **Patsy's** in East Harlem has long been regarded by connoisseurs as serving perhaps the purest example of plain New York-style coal-oven pizza (don't order any toppings, though). Greenwich Village is the center of pizza on Manhattan, home to not only Joe's but also the classic **John's** and the popular **Arturo's**. In Brooklyn, **Grimaldi's** in DUMBO is hugely popular with lines that go down the street, while **Totonno's** on Coney Island and **Di Fara's** in Midwood remain mainstays with the locals. There are also excellent brick-oven establishments serving Neapolitan or other styles of pizza that are not classic New York but well worth having.

New York hot dog

Nothing represents New York street food like the almighty hot dog. Affectionately called "dirty water dogs" by the locals, a New York hot dog is typically all-beef, served in a plain bun, and topped with mustard, ketchup, relish, or any combination of the three. You can get one from pushcarts on seemingly every street corner and park in the city. Just wrap the dog in a paper napkin and walk along the sidewalk trying not to let the toppings slip and slide all over your hands. And of course, both ballparks make sure to keep their fans' hot dog needs satisfied.

However, there are a few places that go a step beyond the typical dirty water dog, with better cooked dogs and a much greater variety of toppings available. Many hot dog enthusiasts make the pilgrimage to the original hot dog stand, **Nathan's** on Coney Island, although locals generally view it as a tourist trap. In Manhattan, **Papaya King** (on the Upper East Side) and **Gray's Papaya** (on the Upper West Side) are favorites, so-named because they also serve tropical drinks with their frankfurters. In addition to their sandwiches, **Katz's** on the Lower East Side is also reputed for an excellent deli dog. In the East Village, **Crif Dogs** draws people in for their deep-fried, beef-and-pork (and often bacon-wrapped!) dogs. **Dominick's** food truck commands a fiercely loyal crowd, who flock to a quiet side of Queens to get a taste. People looking for a good bratwurst should try the **Hallo Berlin** cart on 54th and Fifth in Midtown, while Chicago purists should head to the **Shake Shack** in Madison Square Park.

New York bagel

There is no bagel like the New York bagel anywhere else in the world. Bagels are a doughnut-shaped round of boiled dough that is then baked until it has a distinctive, chewy, sweet interior and a leathery outer crust. They arrived from the Old World with Jewish immigrants from Eastern Europe and have become utterly New York in character. You can get bagels anywhere in the city, but for the best bagels you may have to trek away from the main tourist sites. The key point, though, is get them when they are hot (and that does not mean reheated in the

microwave). Some places actively discourage toasting; try them fresh out of the oven. Good bagel shops will offer a variety of cream cheese spreads and sandwich stuffings, like lox, salmon, tofu spreads, onions, tomatoes, and cucumbers. Many bagel shops are extremely generous with their cream cheese; locals will order "just a schmear" to get a more reasonable amount.

On Manhattan, many people swear by **Ess'a Bagel** in Midtown, with their giant bagels and huge variety of toppings, although bagel purists respect **Murray's** in Greenwich Village and Chelsea for their refusal to allow toasting. Other places in Manhattan which command fiercely loyal followings are **Brooklyn Bagel**, also in Chelsea, and **Absolute Bagels** on the Upper West Side. In Brooklyn, **Bagel Hole** in Park Slope is a no-frills place with smaller bagels, and is often ranked as one of the top bagels in the city, while over in a quiet section of Queens, **Bagel Oasis** is regularly considered among the very best.

New York pastrami sandwich

Another delicacy brought over by Jewish immigrants, pastrami sandwiches are another specialty of New York City. A "Reuben", a grilled sandwich piled high with corned beef, Swiss cheese, Russian dressing and sauerkraut between two slices of rye bread, is always a good choice, though it is not kosher as it violates the Jewish prohibition on mixing meat and dairy. A good deli sandwich doesn't come cheap: be prepared to spend upwards of \$20 for a good sandwich, due to the fact that these meats are prepared using natural methods now outmoded by artificial flavorings and mass production. Many delis also serve other Jewish specialties, such as matzo ball soup.



Corned beef piled high on rye: a Reuben at Katz's 

If you want pastrami, your best bet is **Katz's Delicatessen**, an institution on the Lower East Side that's been serving up excellent sandwiches for over a century. **2nd Ave Deli** in Murray Hill is a famous kosher deli that's a real throwback to the Jewish delis of old. And if you find yourself over in East Brooklyn, **Mill Basin Deli** is known for some of the best pastrami in Brooklyn. In the Bronx, **Liebman's Deli** continues to hold the fort.

New York desserts

Another New York claim to fame is the **New York cheesecake**, which relies upon heavy cream, cream cheese, eggs and egg yolks to add a richness and a smooth consistency. It was made famous by **Junior's**, which still commands a loyal crowd with two locations in Midtown, although the original is in Downtown Brooklyn. Other favorites are **Eileen's** in NoLiTa, **Lady M** and **Two Little Red Hens** in the Upper East Side and **S&S** in the Bronx (whose cheesecake is also sold at Zabar's on the Upper West Side).

Another dessert of New York origin is the **egg cream**, also often referred to as a "chocolate egg cream", a blend of chocolate syrup, milk, and seltzer water (note the curious absence of either egg or cream). Though not often on the menu at many diners, many will still prepare one for you if you ask for one. You can also find them in surprising places, like the tiny Ray's Candy Store in the East Village.

Restaurants

Maybe it's the size of New Yorkers' tiny kitchens, or perhaps it's the enormous melting-pot immigrant populations, but either way, this city excels at every kind of restaurant. There are fancy famous-chef restaurants, all ethnic cuisines and fusion/updates of ethnic cuisines (second-generation immigrants tweaking their family tradition), plus all the fashionable spots, casual bistros, lounges for drinking and noshing and more.

It's only a slight exaggeration to say that virtually every type of cuisine is available in New York. And in some neighborhoods you'll find many national and regional styles represented. However, certain neighborhoods, particularly those in Queens, really shine in terms of the sheer variety available to visitors. While Manhattan's high rents often result in expensive restaurants and sometimes watered-down, unnaturally sweetened food, Queens' vast array of cuisines are often served primarily to patrons from the countries where they originated. Not that Manhattan is completely bereft by any stretch, however: a wide variety of Chinese options can be found in Chinatown and the East Village, there's the small Koreatown with some very good (but not necessarily cheap) restaurants, Washington Heights is the center for Dominican food, the East Village is full of Japanese eateries of various types, and part of Murray Hill is known as "Curry Hill" for its proliferation of Indian restaurants. But in Queens, Flushing offers a vast and diverse array of Chinese (including Northeastern, Sichuan, Hunanese, Shanghainese, etc.), Korean, and Indian eateries; Jackson Heights includes a prominent Indian section among a vast Latin American neighborhood whose eateries span the American continents from Chilean to Mexican and almost everything in between; nearby Elmhurst features various Southeast Asian (for example Vietnamese and Thai, with a couple of Indonesian and Malaysian restaurants thrown in) and Chinese cuisines; Long Island City has locally well-known halal restaurants among a very diverse set of good establishments; nearby Astoria is best known for its Mediterranean food; and Rego Park has Uzbek dining halls. In Brooklyn, Brighton Beach is noted for its Russian eateries, while Sunset Park is home to a third Chinatown as well as plenty of Malaysian and Vietnamese options. Italian options can be found in virtually every neighborhood, although a higher number appear in Staten Island, the East Village, Greenwich Village, heavily Italian parts of Brooklyn like Bensonhurst and Bay Ridge, and the area around Arthur Avenue in the Bronx. (Italian restaurants in Manhattan's "Little Italy" are mostly for tourists only, and New Yorkers generally avoid Mulberry St. between Canal and Broome. Likewise, you would be hard pressed to find locals eating in the chain restaurants [including chain pizzerias] around Times Square.)

Due to the higher cost of living, you are in general expected to tip more in New York City than in other parts of the U.S. As a general rule, tips should start at 18% of the cost of the meal for adequate service, and may go up to 25% for service that goes above and beyond what is expected.

Dress codes

Restaurants with entrees under \$35 are unlikely to have any preference about what their customers wear. Of course, like most major cities, New York has some expensive, extremely fashionable restaurants that care about, and enforce, a certain level of dress among their customers - but "jackets only" restaurants are very uncommon nowadays to the point at which the restaurant's reputation would make the fact known.

If you're from elsewhere in the US and wish to "pass" as a local within Manhattan, pay attention to your shoes and coat. Most local exclusiveness is pretty understated, but where it exists it's generally to distinguish locals from nightlife commuters from New Jersey and Long Island that supposedly threaten to rob bar-filled neighborhoods of their local color. Therefore, if your style doesn't fit in but is obviously from outside the US, you may find yourself welcomed as graciously as any local, if not more so.

Vegetarians

Vegetarians and vegans will find New York to be a paradise with hundreds of vegetarian-only restaurants and good veggie options in even the most expensive places. There are many vegetarian-only restaurants with offerings varying from macrobiotic food to Ayurvedic thalis or Asian Buddhist food. But, more importantly, almost every restaurant at every point on the price scale has vegetarian dishes that are more than an afterthought. Even **Per Se**, one of the most expensive and sought after restaurants in the city, has a seven course vegetarian tasting menu well worth the expense. DIY vegetarians will have no problem finding fresh vegetables, a wide variety of cheese, bread, and prepared vegetarian foods in New York supermarkets.

Street food

Nothing differentiates New York more from other American (and European) cities than the astonishing amount of food cooked and served on the streets. Starting with the thousands of hot dog stands on almost every street corner, the possibilities are endless. People trek to Jackson Heights in Queens for a nibble of the famous arepas of the **Arepa Lady**. Freshly cooked Indian dosas are served up for a pittance at the **NY Dosas** stand in Washington Square Park. The **Trinipak** cart on 43rd and Sixth in Midtown serves delicious Trinidadian/Pakistani food. Danny Meyer, the famous restaurateur, runs the burger stand **Shake Shack** in Madison Square Park as well as several other locations throughout the city.

The halal offerings in Midtown are legendary (**Kwik-Meal** on 45th and Sixth; **Halal Guys** on 53rd and Sixth and many others). Most carts serve lunch from about 11AM to 5 or 6PM in the evening and disappear after dark, so look for a cart near you, smell what's cooking, and enjoy a hot and often tasty lunch for a few dollars (a meal costs anywhere from about \$2 to \$8). Mornings, from about 6AM to 10AM, the streets are dotted with coffee carts that sell coffee, croissants, bagels, and Danish pastries and are



One of the many, many food carts in the city



good for a cheap breakfast: small coffee and bagel for a dollar or so. From 10AM to 7PM, many vendors sell lunch and dinner choices, including hot dogs, hamburgers, gyros, and halal. Other street vendors sell Italian ices, pretzels, ice cream, and roasted peanuts. Also, look around for the coffee truck (often found in Union Square), dessert truck, and the Belgian waffle truck that roam around the city.

Do it yourself

New York's many markets and grocery stores make preparing your own food interesting and easy. Almost every grocery store, deli, or bodega has a prepared foods section where you can make your own salad (beware, you are charged by the pound!) or buy ready-to-eat foods such as burritos, tacos, curries and rice, lasagna, pastas, pre-made or freshly-made sandwiches, and many other types of foods. Any supermarket will have enough to take away to the park or your hotel room for a low-cost meal. **Whole Foods** has five New York City locations, all with a variety of foods and a clean place to sit and eat. **Zabar's** on the Upper West Side is very famous, with a huge selection of foodstuffs and expensive foods as well as cooking supplies. There is also a **Trader Joe's** at Union Square and in 6 other locations in every borough but the Bronx for cheap but delicious supermarket buys, and **Western Beef** supermarkets offer more foods from different ethnicities than average supermarkets.

If you have a place to cook, you'll find almost any kind of food in New York, though you may have to travel to the outer boroughs for ethnic ingredients. Most supermarkets have Thai, Chinese, and Indian sauces to add flavor to your pot; many, especially in Upper Manhattan, have the ingredients necessary for a Mexican or Central American meal; and there are several H-Mart supermarkets around town for Korean ingredients and prepared foods; but go to Chinatown for the best Chinese ingredients, Little India in Murray Hill for Indian ingredients, Flushing for all things Chinese or Korean, Jackson Heights for Peruvian, Ecuadorian, and South Asian, Flatbush and Crown Heights for Jamaican, Williamsburg for Kosher, and Greenpoint for Polish. Ask around for where you can get your favorite ethnic ingredients and you'll find traveling around in local neighborhoods a rewarding experience.

Drink

Last call can be as late as 4AM, although many establishments will let you stay beyond that, especially in the outer boroughs. It is not uncommon to be locked in a bar after 4AM so people can keep drinking. Wine and liquor are sold at **liquor stores**, and are not sold at delis or supermarkets. Beer cannot be bought between 4AM and 8AM on Sunday morning (although if you look hard, you can get around this).

As in most American cities, drinking alcoholic beverages on the street is illegal. The law is flouted openly in many areas, but bars will not generally let you take your drink outside.

Popular nightlife neighborhoods

The only thing about New York City that changes faster than the subway map or the restaurants is the bar scene. While some established watering holes have been around for decades or centuries, the hot spot of the moment may well have opened last week and could likely close just as quickly.

On Manhattan, **Greenwich Village** is probably the best neighborhood to go if you are in town for just a brief period, full of locals of all ages, especially students attending NYU. **Chelsea** has lots of clubs and a thriving gay scene, and if you are European and looking for a discothèque, this is where you want to be. The **Meatpacking District** holds trendier bars and clubs and some expensive restaurants. The **Lower East Side**, formerly the dingy alternative to the West Village, has become trendier today, with an influx of hipsters. The **East Village** also has lots of bars, as well as a sizeable cluster of Japanese bars. Nearby, **Alphabet City**, once a dangerous drug-addled hell hole, has since cleaned up and is loaded with bars. **Murray Hill** is more hip with the 30-year-old crowd, with many Indian restaurants and plenty of watering holes, including a couple of fireman bars and an all Irish whiskey pub. **Times Square** is a very touristy area with a few classy hotel rooftop bars, although very few New Yorkers would be caught dead at these places.

In Brooklyn, **Williamsburg** is the capital of NYC's hipster scene, and many of New York's small music venues are here. **Bay Ridge** has one of the highest concentrations of bars in the city in a neighborhood that has been generally Irish/Italian and does not have the hipster/yuppie scene common in New York. **Park Slope**, however, is the yuppie capital of New York and you are more likely to find a tea house serving soy milk than a bar here. There is some low-key nightlife, although this has been on the decline. A number of lesbian bars are in this area.

Queens is home to **Woodside**, an Irish neighborhood great for happy hour and drinking festivities before a Mets baseball game. **Astoria** is home to Queens' Bohemian Hall Beer Garden, which covers an entire city block, is walled and filled with trees, indoor and outdoor tables and a cool crowd, and serves great Czech and German beer. And on Staten Island, **St. George** has a few bars located south of the ferry terminal, with good live music.

Jazz

NYC has a pretty confident claim to be the world capital of jazz. It exerts a brain drain influence on the rest of the country's most talented jazz musicians, and the live music scene is simply thriving. This goes for all styles of jazz, (except pre-swing trad jazz, which safely belongs to New Orleans): Latin, modern, fusion, experimental, bebop, hard bop, you name it. **The Blue Note** in Greenwich Village is probably the most famous extant jazz club in the world, with nightly headliners and cover charges to match. The **Village Vanguard** is a legendary hole-in-the-wall (also in Greenwich Village), having played host to most of the greats going back to 1935. Other top (i.e., famous—there are fabulous lesser-known places to hear jazz throughout the city) clubs include **Birdland** in the Theater District and the **Cotton Club** in Harlem. If the high cover charges in this expensive city are giving you the blues, look at **Smalls** and **Cellar Dog**, which are within a block of each other in Greenwich Village and keep the covers as low as possible, so that musicians can actually afford to come!

Salsa

Would it be too provocative to declare New York the home of salsa? Possibly, but there's a reason to consider it. Salsa originated in Cuba, but its second home was New York (especially the Bronx), where it truly exploded and developed into a global phenomenon, driven by innovations from Cuban and later Puerto Rican immigrants. Latin dance, particularly salsa (danced on the two) and other Afro-Caribbean varieties, remains enormously popular, although it's now centered more on a semi-professional ballroom-dancing crowd rather than Latino communities.

The **Copacabana** near Times Square dates back to 1940, and is probably the city's best known Latin dance club. Other well known options include **Club Cache** also near Times Square, the very Dominican **El Morocco** in Spanish Harlem, and **Iguana** in west Midtown. Many venues in the city hold a salsa night once a week, so poke around the city papers for event listings.

Sleep

Hotels

New York has some of the most expensive accommodations in the world. Expect to pay \$100–\$200 for a budget room with shared bath, \$250–\$350 for a mid-range hotel with a decent room and a restaurant and/or room service; and much higher in a high end hotel. Most accommodations below \$200 in Manhattan are a small room with space only for a bed, a TV, perhaps a sink, and little else. Cheaper accommodations may have communal bathrooms (although many will have a sink in the room). Be warned that the quality of hotels varies significantly and, in many cheap hotels away from the center such as along the West Side Highway or in the outer reaches of Queens, you may share the premises with hourly customers! As New York is a popular destination throughout the year, it is necessary to make reservations well in advance. If you plan to be in the city during the height of the tourist season, booking months in advance would be wise. The two largest hotels in New York City are the Marriott Marquis (<https://www.marriott.com/en-us/hotels/nycmq-new-york-marriott-marquis/overview/>) (on Times Square) and the Hilton Midtown (<https://www.hilton.com/en/hotels/nycnhhh-new-york-hilton-midtown/>) (on 6th Avenue between 53rd and 54th Streets); however, there are many other big-name hotels in the city, so the options are expansive.

Hostels

Expect to pay up to \$50 for a hostel. There are several hostels in Manhattan including an official Hostelling International hostel (located at 891 Amsterdam Avenue—between 102nd and 103rd Streets—in Manhattan), but there are many places that call themselves "hostel" and offer accommodations below \$100 a night. Some cater exclusively to students. You are strongly advised to make reservations months in advance.

Taxes

Room rates are typically quoted excluding taxes, so expect your actual bill to be materially higher than the quoted rate. Taxes include New York State and New York City sales tax (8.875%), a New York City Hotel Occupancy Tax (varies but, for rooms above \$40, \$2 + 5.875%), and a surcharge of \$1.50. For a \$100 per night room, expect to pay \$117.75, after taxes are taken into account.

Alternatives to Manhattan accommodations

You don't have to stay in Manhattan. There are many hotels just outside Manhattan in Long Island City, Queens, Brooklyn and New Jersey that are cheaper than hotels in Manhattan. Also, due to the high accommodation prices and insider knowledge of the locals, you may want to consider a hospitality exchange.

Off-season

Lower accommodation prices are also generally available in January and February, the end of August, and on Sunday nights.

Connect

Free WiFi is available in city parks and quite a few public libraries. The Apple Store has dozens of computers set up and doesn't seem to mind that many people use them for free internet access, but they can be pretty busy at times. Easy Internet Cafe and FedEx Office are just some of the internet cafes which offer broadband internet at reasonable prices. Finding a store with an open power outlet may be difficult so be sure your device is fully charged and its battery is working properly. There are now some free phone charging stations on the street if you are running out of power. Remember to include the 1 and area code when dialing from any phone in New York City - including private "land line" phones in buildings - as 11-digit dialing is always in effect, even when dialing locally. However, you don't need to dial 1 from a cell phone.

Stay safe



Cautions about firearms: New York City has some of the nation's strictest gun laws, and handgun permits issued elsewhere — including New York State licenses — are not honored within the five boroughs of the city.

Some popular venues have a "No guns" sign posted outside, leading people to falsely assume such weapons are prohibited only in certain places. In fact, they're just as illegal outside these venues as inside. Attempting to leave weapons with security guards or police prior to entry will likely lead to very serious criminal charges.

Since Feb 2023, New York City's gun laws have been in flux after the U.S. Supreme Court struck down the city's gun permit law as unconstitutional. It is still advisable to avoid bringing a gun to New York City, even if you're just passing through by air (LaGuardia and JFK) or by car.

New York is the safest large city in the United States, and its crime rate per person is lower than the national average and the crime rate of many small towns. You can be assured of a high police presence in Times Square, public transportation hubs and other major crowded places.

The most common crime against tourists (not including being overcharged, or scammed in the Times Square area) is bag snatching. Never let go of your handbag (putting other bags down is OK, as long as you guard them carefully), especially in the subway but also when eating at a restaurant. Take special care if you are sitting outdoors or in a crowded self-service restaurant. Leave your passport and other valuables that you don't need to carry in a hotel safe or hidden in your suitcase. Don't flaunt a wad of money if you can help it; if you want to be safer, count your money in your room before you go out and take only what you think you may need. Unless you have protective outer wear, consider not wearing expensive jewelry, and hide valuables like cameras when you're not using them.

While muggings are rare, they do happen. Take a tip from seasoned New Yorkers and always try to be aware of who's walking near you in all directions (especially behind you), at all times. Always be aware of your surroundings, especially if you find yourself on a lightly traveled or poorly lit street. Certain neighborhoods that are off the tourist path can be avoided in the Bronx, Brooklyn, Queens, and Staten Island. Riverside Park and Central Park are less safe at night, so stick to well-lit paths if you walk there after dark. If you go to an evening outdoor concert at one of the parks, follow the crowd out of the park before heading toward your destination.

If you think you've inadvertently wandered into a dangerous area, hop into a cab, if available, or into the nearest subway station and go elsewhere, and if none of those is an option, don't hesitate to cross the street or duck into an open shop. If a subway platform is deserted, stay within sight of the station agent if possible. Trust your instincts; if a station or street feels unsafe, it's best to leave. In some areas (like the East New York LIRR station) helpful locals may even assist you in finding a safer place to go, or will wait/walk with you!

Airport-style security is common at buildings, museums and tourist attractions, even the Main Branch of the New York Public Library. Generally you can expect to have your bags checked (either manually by a security guard or through an x-ray machine) and walk through a metal detector. Unlike their counterparts at JFK and LaGuardia, security screenings at building entrances are surprisingly quick and efficient - and you can even leave your shoes on!

New York has its share of odd people: talkative pan-handlers, lonely people just wanting a chat, religious preachers, people with psychological disorders, etc. If you prefer not to speak with someone who approaches you for a chat, do what most New Yorkers do: completely ignore them or say "Sorry, gotta go" while continuing to walk at a brisk pace.

Watch out for cyclists and even motorcyclists riding, sometimes at high speeds, on the sidewalk or the wrong way on one-way streets. This has become a constant in some neighborhoods. Also, you will notice that New Yorkers routinely jaywalk (fun fact: jaywalking was legalized in New York City in 2025), but don't do it yourself unless you have good sight lines and can do so safely.

Despite the stereotypes, many New Yorkers are nice people and don't mind giving out directions (time allowing), so don't be afraid to ask! If you ever get into trouble, approach the nearest police officer. You'll find them to be friendly, polite, and very helpful.

Cope

Water

The quality of tap water in New York City is considered to be among the best in the world (unless you are in an old building with outdated plumbing). There is generally no good reason to drink bottled water in preference to New York City tap water. Lower-end restaurants will simply place glasses of ice water on your table (and refill them constantly, for free). At nicer restaurants you will be asked "what kind of water" you want. Asking for tap water is completely acceptable in any restaurant; your other choices are "bottled" (non-carbonated water, such as Fiji or Evian) or "sparkling" (which almost always means Pellegrino).

Noise

Being the largest city in the country, New York City is true to its reputation as the "city that never sleeps". Traffic, honking horns, the loud chatter on the streets, musicians busking, and sirens are all undeniable parts of the city's soundscape.

Consider buying a pair of earplugs or noise cancelling headphones to deal with the excessive noise.

Toilets

Public restrooms are few and far between in New York City. The parks department maintains a list of "comfort stations" in their parks (<https://www.nycgovparks.org/facilities/bathrooms>), and the one at Bryant Park (<https://www.nycgovparks.org/parks/bryant-park>) in Manhattan is even something of a tourist attraction. Public libraries also have free restrooms, and some subway stations (<https://new.mta.info/agency/new-york-city-transit/bathrooms>) have restrooms open during the day. There are a small number of self-cleaning, coin-operated toilets in the city, which require quarters (25¢) and are always wheelchair-accessible. Large stores and sit-down restaurants usually have restrooms for paying customers. Otherwise, look for a church or police station that's open and ask if you can use the restroom.

Information

- **Citizen Service Center**, ☎ 311 (lines open 24/7). New York City's official non-emergency help line, available in 171 languages for questions (parade hours and routes, parking restrictions, transport problems) and complaints (litter, noise pollution, access).

Babysitting

- **Baby Sitters' Guild** (<http://www.babysittersguild.com>), ☎ +1-212-682-0227. Bookings 9AM–9PM daily, cash payments only. For stressed and busy parents visiting New York, round-the-clock baby-sitting is available short- or long-term from \$20 per hour (4-hour minimum) and cab fare (approx. \$10). Multilingual sitters are also available.

Smoking

Smoking in public places is highly restricted. It is prohibited in indoor sections of bars, restaurants, subway stations and trains (all transit system property), public parks, public beaches, pedestrian malls, both indoor and outdoor stadiums and sports arenas, and many other public places. If you light up in any of these places, you are subject to a summons and fine, ejection, and/or indignant reactions from residents. There do remain a small number of legal cigar bars that are exempt, as are the outside areas of sidewalk cafes and the like, but these are very much the exception. If you need to smoke while eating or drinking, be prepared to take a break and join the rest of the smokers outside, whatever the weather; many establishments have large space heaters.

There is also some vaping on the streets of New York.

Cannabis/marijuana and other drugs

Cannabis is legal in New York for those 21 or older. Adults may possess up to 3 ounces of marijuana or up to 24 grams of cannabis concentrate and consume it anywhere tobacco smoking is permitted — it is the only jurisdiction in the USA where public marijuana smoking is legal. You will smell it walking down the street with some frequency.

New Yorkers are embracing legal weed with typical impatience and irreverence, and cannabis sales occur openly in every tourist-dominated area of the city, including Times Square and most Manhattan & Brooklyn parks.

Because NYC law only prohibits driving under the influence of cannabis and possession thereof by minors/children, you'll be hard-pressed to find a cop who'll lift a finger to stop open cannabis sales (they have bigger fish to fry), though unfortunately the way a dealer is treated by police often depends on skin color. Purchase cannabis at your own risk, but only the dealer commits a crime.

Purchasing hard drugs in New York City is dangerous. Penalties for possession are draconian, including long prison sentences, and legal representation is expensive. Fake hard drugs and hard drugs laced with poisonous fentanyl are common.

Consulates

New York City is home to diplomatic missions from virtually every country on Earth due to the presence of the United Nations. Most countries have consulates here that double as the permanent mission to the United Nations, even if a country may otherwise not have diplomatic relations with the United States.

Diplomatic missions	list[Expand]
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Go next

Locals would ask why you ever want to leave, but New York is a great jumping-off point to other locations in the metro area (including New Jersey and Connecticut) or anywhere in the Boston-Washington Megalopolis corridor.

New Jersey

Despite being a constant target of mockery and jokes from New York, the densely-populated Garden State has plenty of great attractions to offer nearby:

- **Hudson Waterfront** — The portion of New Jersey that directly faces Manhattan along the Hudson River. The region is traversed by the 18.5-mile-long (29.8 km) **Hudson River Waterfront Walkway** that runs, albeit discontinuously, from the George Washington Bridge down to the city of Bayonne and offers clear views of the Manhattan skyline.
- **Jersey City** — Directly across the Hudson River from the Financial District is New Jersey's second largest city. Jersey City is a diverse city with lots of multicultural shops and restaurants, and it is often referred to as New York's "sixth borough". It can be reached from Manhattan via the Holland Tunnel, the PATH trains (the bi-state subway),

buses from Port Authority or the many ferries that zip passengers across the Hudson River.

- **Hoboken** — Directly across the Hudson River from the West Village and Chelsea is the alleged birthplace of baseball (most erroneously believe that the birthplace is Cooperstown, NY) and actual birthplace of Frank Sinatra. Hoboken is a small city in area with a great assortment of prewar buildings and conspicuous lack of many corporate establishments. The piers have great views of Manhattan, a large selection of bars, restaurants, and clubs, and are a good place to walk around. Hoboken can be reached from Manhattan by the PATH train or by bus from Port Authority as well as by NY Waterway ferries.
- **Fort Lee** — Occupying the western end of the George Washington Bridge, Fort Lee is home to the site of the eponymous Revolutionary War fort, as well as a high concentration of Korean and Japanese restaurants that spill deep into the neighboring towns. Fort Lee is easily reached by walking, biking, or taking a bus/jitney across the George Washington Bridge from the adjacent bus terminal on the Manhattan side of the bridge.
- **Jersey Shore** — The Jersey Shore starts just a few miles south of New York City. It stretches for almost 130 mi (210 km), and along it are private and public beaches. There are numerous activities along the Jersey Shore. Sandy Hook, part of the National Gateway Area and home to one of the few nude beaches around New York, Gunnison Beach, can be easily accessed using the SeaStreak ferry from Manhattan. The service operates during the beach season and goes directly to the Hook. A convenient train ride on the NJ Transit trains from Penn Station will get you to several more of the towns on the Jersey Shore, including Asbury Park, Manasquan and Point Pleasant Beach. Buses from Port Authority also take passengers to other spots along the Jersey Shore not served by train from New York, such as Seaside Heights.
 - **Atlantic City**, **Wildwood**, and **Cape May** at the southern edge of New Jersey are home to beaches, casinos in Atlantic City, restaurants, shopping, and entertainment. Just a 2-hour drive from New York, and plenty of buses also operate to Atlantic City from Port Authority.
- **Six Flags Great Adventure** in Jackson — An 80-minute drive from Manhattan sits the largest regional theme park in the world. Six Flags Great Adventure features plenty of monster roller coasters and is next to the Wild Safari (one of the largest drive-through safaris in the world). There is also Six Flags Hurricane Harbor right next door (the largest water park in the Northeast). New Jersey Transit provides bus service from the Port Authority Bus Terminal in Manhattan when the park is open (May–October).
- **Princeton** — Also an easy train ride on New Jersey Transit, Princeton offers a quiet, tree-lined town, good for strolling or for visiting the Princeton University campus. Take the Northeast Corridor line to Princeton Junction, then transfer to the shuttle train (known locally as the "Dinky") to ride directly into campus.
- **Newark** — Although most tourists only come here to arrive or depart in the city's international airport, Newark is also home to Branch Brook Park, which contains one of the largest collections of cherry trees in the nation and makes for a great day trip during cherry blossom season in the spring, and the Ironbound, a district full of Portuguese, Brazilian, and Spanish restaurants and cuisine. Newark is a major transport hub in the New York area, with NJ Transit and PATH trains frequently operating to/from Midtown and Lower Manhattan.
- **Paterson** is a sizable, diverse city whose main attraction, the very extensive Great Falls of the Passaic River, is worth a trip if you have extra time during your visit to New York.

New York (state)

- **Long Island** — Many New Yorkers visit Long Island's beautiful long white sand beaches during the summer. You can take the Long Island Rail Road from Penn Station to Long Beach (\$9.00 off-peak or \$12.50 peak), and go to the beach there, or another option is to

take a long day trip on the Hampton Jitney from various stops in NYC to the East End, where Long Island wine country is on the North Fork and The Hamptons are on the South Fork.

- **Fire Island** — an all-pedestrian summer-resort island off the coast of Long Island. Fire Island is home to many vacation communities on the western part of the island (Ocean Beach being the most populous, with the most restaurants and bars that make an excellent day trip). The eastern part of the island is home to the largely gay communities of Cherry Grove and the Fire Island Pines. Western Fire Island is reachable by ferry from Bay Shore on Long Island. Bay Shore is about an hour's train ride on the Long Island Rail Road from Manhattan, and the ferry ride from Bay Shore is another 30 minutes. Ferries to Ocean Beach from Bay Shore run about once every hour during the summer. Cherry Grove and the Fire Island Pines are reachable by ferry from Sayville. The easternmost community, Davis Park, is reachable by ferry from Patchogue.
- **The Palisades** — On the western bank of the Hudson River, there are cliffs that rise sharply. These cliffs are known as the Palisades. They range from 300 to 500 feet. They start in the northern portion of Jersey City and stretch all the way to Nyack, New York. There are numerous viewpoints, trails and campsites along the Palisades. The Palisades can be easily reached from Manhattan via the George Washington Bridge. Palisade Interstate Park and Parkway start north of the bridge.
- **Westchester County** and the **Hudson Valley** — Home to the country's only government-operated theme park - Rye Playland - as well as beautiful neighborhoods. There are pretty communities along the Long Island Sound and inland, and the Hudson Valley (which extends north of Westchester) is truly beautiful; the train route (Metro North Hudson Line to Poughkeepsie or Amtrak to Albany) along the Hudson River is one of the loveliest in the country. Westchester County starts just north of the NYC borough of the Bronx.
- **The Adirondacks** are the largest state park in the United States, and are only a 3- to 4-hour drive away on I-87. The area is home to mountains, small villages, and winter sports.
- Western New York is the land of the **Finger Lakes**, **Niagara Falls**, **Thousand Islands**, and nice towns. Up to an 8-hour drive on the Thruway.
- The **Woodbury Commons** in Orange County is one of the largest outlet shopping centers in the Northeast, with over 200 stores. Take exit 16 (Harriman) on I-87. If you don't have a car, there are several bus alternatives from Manhattan like Gray Line New York, Hampton Luxury Liner and Manhattan Transfer tours.

New England

- **New Haven, Connecticut** — 75 miles (121 km) away, New Haven is a 1-hour-45-minute ride from Grand Central Terminal via Metro North Railroad, and home to Yale University. Megabus and Greyhound also provide transportation.
- **Cape Cod**, a 5-hour drive from New York north on I-95, is home to nice towns, restaurants, beaches, shopping, and entertainment. Also accessible by Peter Pan Bus Lines.
- **Boston, Massachusetts** — Beantown, home to the Freedom Trail, incredible seafood, Harvard University in nearby Cambridge, and the Boston Red Sox (who are the most hated sports team of most New Yorkers), is 4 hours north on I-95 (\$32-38 one way by bus on Greyhound and Peter Pan; Megabus sometimes charges more), with a bus from Port Authority Bus Terminal every hour around the clock or \$20-102 one way on Amtrak's Northeast Regional from Penn Station as of April 2024 if bought far enough in advance.
- The rest of **New England** has a lot to offer, including national parks, beaches, mountains and skiing.

Elsewhere

- **Philadelphia** — The birthplace of American independence and the nation's first capital is 1 hour 20 minutes away by Amtrak, very feasible for a day trip or side trip from New York City.

A cheaper but somewhat slower method of getting there is to either take the NJ Transit Northeast Corridor Line to Trenton and change for SEPTA or take a bus from Midtown or Chinatown.

- **Washington, D.C.** is the capital of the United States and a three-hour train ride on the Acela. The National Mall, the White House, and the Lincoln Memorial are just a few of the numerous attractions that D.C. has to offer.
- There are more beaches to check out in **Delaware** and **Maryland**, such as **Ocean City** and **Rehoboth Beach**
- **Montreal** is a 7-hour drive away, plus time to go through the checkpoint at the border. Also accessible by plane, Greyhound and Trailways and by a slow Amtrak trip.

For routeboxes with commuter rail trains, see Manhattan or other borough articles.

Routes through New York City (by long-distance train)

Washington, D.C. ← Newark ←	SW AMTRAK Acela Express NE	→ Stamford → Boston
Albany (Rensselaer) ← Yonkers ←	N AMTRAK Adirondack AMTRAK Empire Service AMTRAK Maple Leaf S	→ END
Philadelphia ← Newark ←	W AMTRAK Cardinal E	→ END
END ←	N AMTRAK Crescent AMTRAK Palmetto AMTRAK Silver Meteor AMTRAK Silver Star S	→ Newark → Philadelphia
Philadelphia ← Newark ←	W AMTRAK Keystone Service AMTRAK Pennsylvanian E	→ END
Albany (Rensselaer) ← Croton-on-Hudson ←	N AMTRAK Lake Shore Limited S	→ END
Philadelphia ← Newark ←	SW AMTRAK Northeast Regional NE	→ New Rochelle → New Haven
Philadelphia ← Newark ←	SW AMTRAK Vermonter NE	→ Stamford → New Haven

Routes through New York City (by car)

Allentown ← Jersey City ←	W 78 E	→ END
Albany ← Yonkers ←	N 87 S	→ END
New Haven ← New Rochelle ←	N 95 1 S	→ Fort Lee → Philadelphia
Linden ← Elizabeth ←	W 278 E	→ Merges into 95 N
Weehawken ← Becomes 495 ←	W 495 E	→ Plainview → Riverhead
Albany ← Yonkers ←	N 9 S	→ Fort Lee → Cape May
New Haven ← Mount Vernon ←	N 28 S	→ END

